

CLASS IX – INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (402)

Part B – Subject Specific Skills

Unit 3: Digital Documentation

Session 1: Creating a Document Using a Word Processor

Software Used: LibreOffice Writer

Important: The correct name is **LibreOffice Writer**, not “LibreOffice Write”.

1. Introduction to Digital Documentation

Digital Documentation means creating, editing, formatting, storing and sharing documents in digital form using a computer or other electronic device.

Examples of digital documents:

- Letters
- Applications
- Reports
- Notices
- Resumes
- School assignments
- Question papers
- Business documents

A **word processor** is one of the most commonly used applications for creating digital documents.

LibreOffice Writer

LibreOffice Writer is a free and open-source **word processing application** included in the LibreOffice office suite.

It can be used to:

- Create documents
- Type and edit text
- Format text and paragraphs
- Insert images and shapes

- Create tables
 - Check spelling and grammar
 - Add headers and footers
 - Create columns
 - Save and print documents
-

2. What is a Word Processor?

A **Word Processor** is a software application used to **create, edit, format, save, print and manage text-based documents**.

Examples of Word Processors

- LibreOffice Writer
- Microsoft Word
- Google Docs
- WPS Writer
- Apple Pages

Example

If you want to prepare a school application, instead of writing it manually on paper, you can type it in **LibreOffice Writer**, format it, save it and print it.

3. Features and Applications of Word Processors

Word processors provide many features that make document creation easier and faster.

3.1 Fast

A word processor allows us to type and create documents quickly.

Example:

A long letter can be typed, edited and formatted much faster than writing it by hand.

3.2 Editing Features

Text can easily be modified after typing.

We can:

- Add text
- Delete text
- Move text
- Copy text
- Paste text
- Undo changes
- Redo changes
- Find text
- Replace text

Example:

If you make a spelling mistake, you can correct it without rewriting the entire document.

3.3 Permanent Storage

Documents can be saved on:

- Computer hard disk/SSD
- Pen drive
- External storage
- Cloud storage

A saved document can be opened and used later.

Example:

A school report created today can be saved and edited next month.

3.4 Formatting

Formatting changes the appearance of text and documents.

We can change:

- Font type
- Font size
- Font colour
- Font style

- Alignment
- Line spacing
- Paragraph indentation
- Page orientation
- Margins

Example:

Computer Education

can be formatted using a different font, size and colour.

3.5 Graphics

Word processors allow us to insert graphical objects such as:

- Pictures
- Shapes
- Diagrams
- Charts
- Logos

Graphics make documents more attractive and easier to understand.

3.6 OLE – Object Linking and Embedding

OLE stands for **Object Linking and Embedding**.

It is a technology that allows an object created in one application to be **inserted into another application**.

For example, a spreadsheet or chart created in a spreadsheet program can be inserted into a Writer document.

Linking vs Embedding

Linking

The inserted object remains connected to the original file.

Embedding

A copy of the object is placed inside the document.

Linking

Changes in the original object can be reflected in the document.

Requires access to the source file.

Embedding

Changes to the original file normally do not automatically change the embedded object.

Object becomes part of the document.

3.7 Spell Check

A word processor can identify many spelling mistakes.

For example:

Computar ❌

Computer ✅

LibreOffice Writer can also provide grammar checking depending on the installed language tools.

Note: Spell checking does not guarantee that every sentence is grammatically or factually correct.

3.8 Mail Merge

Mail Merge is a feature used to create multiple documents with the **same main content but different personal information**.

For example, a school can create invitation letters for 100 students using one common letter and a list containing:

- Student Name
- Class
- Roll Number
- Address

Instead of typing 100 letters separately, Mail Merge can automatically generate personalized letters.

Common applications

- Invitation letters
- Certificates
- Address labels

- Circulars
 - Notices
 - Business letters
-

4. Working with LibreOffice Writer

The basic process of creating a document is:

Create/Open → Type → Edit → Format → Save → Close

Step 1: Create or Open a Document

Create a new document or open an existing document.

Step 2: Type Text

Enter the required text using the keyboard.

Step 3: Edit the Document

Correct mistakes and modify the content if required.

Step 4: Format the Document

Apply suitable formatting such as:

- Bold
- Italic
- Font size
- Alignment
- Paragraph spacing
- Headings

Step 5: Save the Document

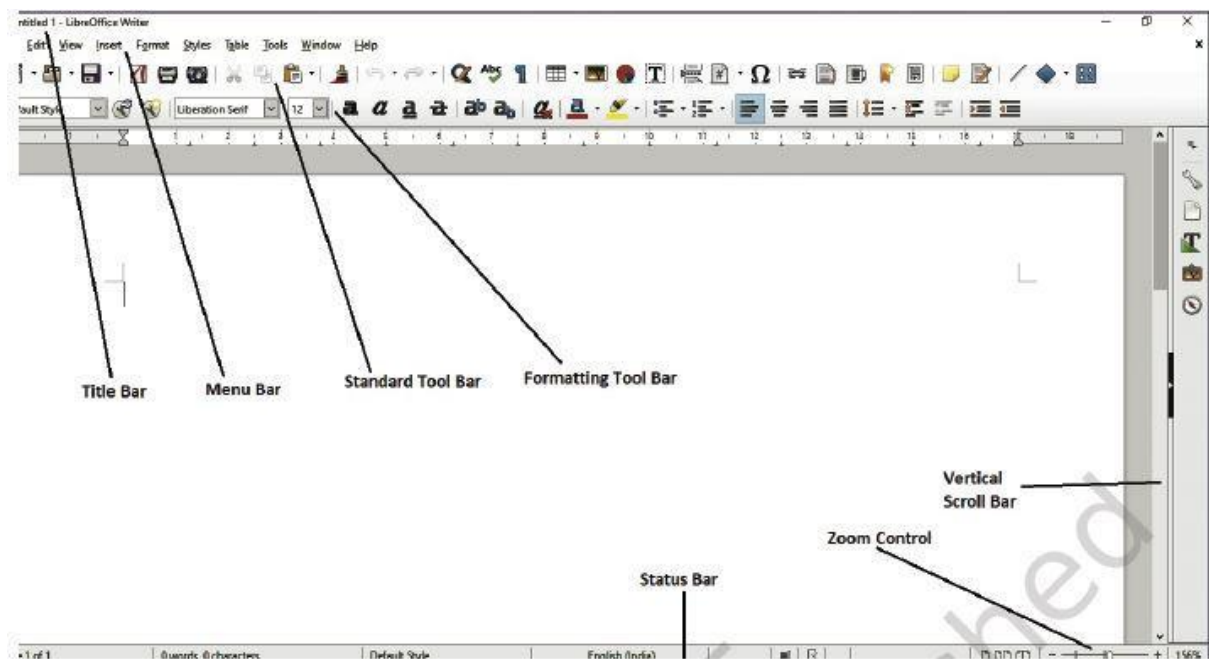
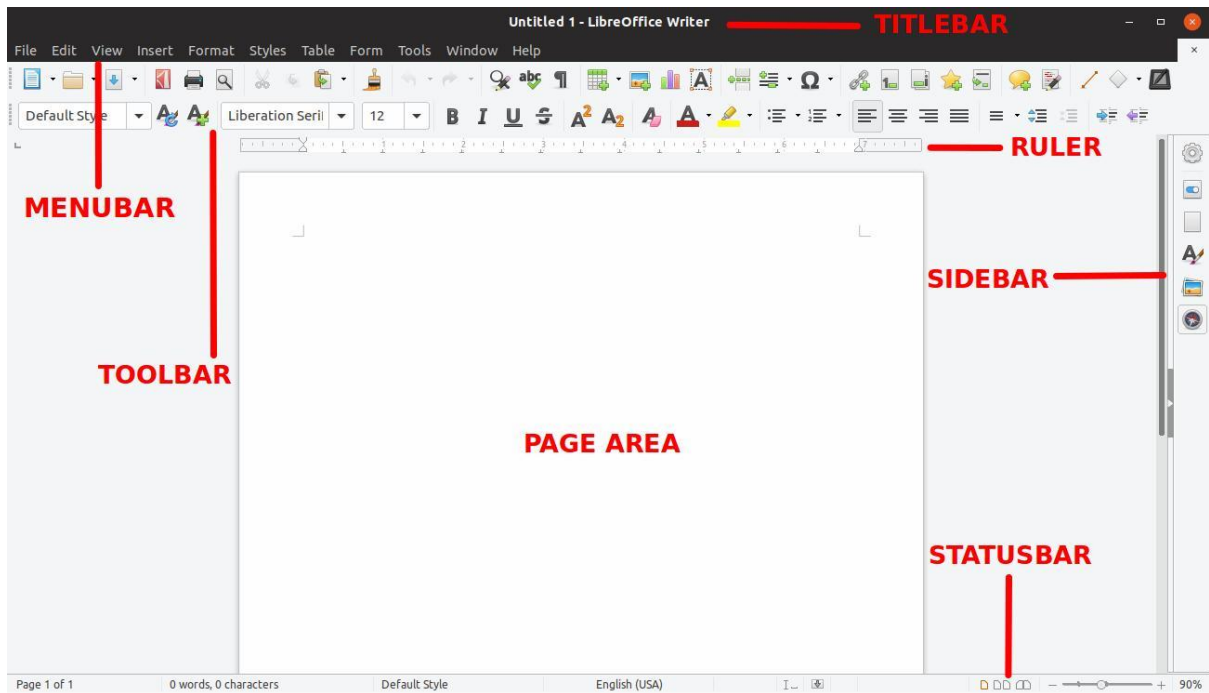
Save the document so that it can be used later.

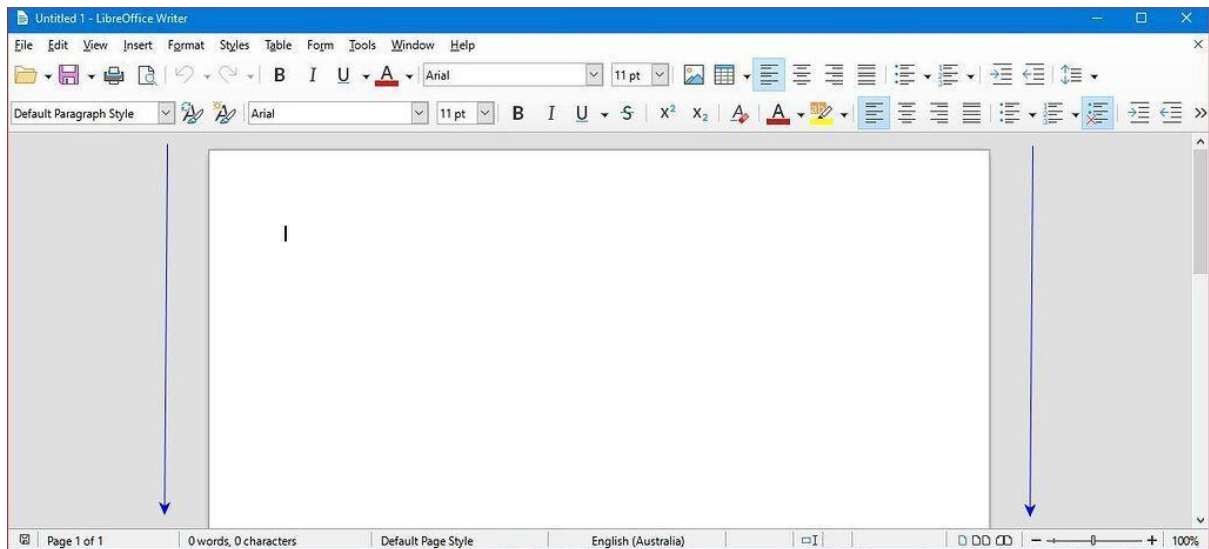
Step 6: Close the Document

After completing the work, close the document.

5. Major Components of the Writer Document Window

The LibreOffice Writer window contains several important components.





5

5.1 Title Bar

The **Title Bar** appears at the top of the window.

It displays:

- Name of the current document
- LibreOffice Writer application name

For a new unsaved document, a temporary name such as **Untitled 1** may be displayed.

5.2 Menu Bar

The **Menu Bar** contains menus that provide commands and functions.

Common menus include:

- File
- Edit
- View
- Insert
- Format
- Styles
- Table
- Form

- Tools
 - Window
 - Help
-

5.3 Standard Toolbar

The **Standard Toolbar** contains commonly used commands such as:

- New
- Open
- Save
- Print
- Undo
- Redo
- Cut
- Copy
- Paste

It provides quick access to frequently used commands.

5.4 Formatting Bar

The **Formatting Bar** contains tools used to format text.

Common options include:

- Font name
- Font size
- Bold
- Italic
- Underline
- Font colour
- Text highlighting
- Alignment

- Line spacing
-

5.5 Ruler

The **Ruler** helps us:

- Set margins
- Set tab stops
- Set paragraph indents
- Position text accurately

Writer normally provides horizontal and vertical rulers depending on the view/settings.

5.6 Status Bar

The **Status Bar** is located at the bottom of the document window.

It provides information about the document, such as:

- Current page
 - Number of pages
 - Word count
 - Language
 - View information
 - Zoom level
-

5.7 Scroll Bar

Scroll bars allow us to move through the document.

- **Vertical scroll bar** – moves up and down.
 - **Horizontal scroll bar** – moves left and right when required.
-

5.8 Work Area / Text Area

The **Work Area** is the main area where we type and edit the document.

It is sometimes called the **document area** or **text area**.

5.9 Zoom Slider

The **Zoom Slider** is generally located on the status bar.

It allows us to increase or decrease the size at which the document is displayed on the screen.

Important: Zoom changes the **display size**, not the actual font size of the document.

6. Document Views

LibreOffice Writer provides different ways to view a document.

6.1 Normal / Print Layout View

This is the normal working view used for creating and editing documents.

It displays the document approximately as it will appear when printed.

Used for:

Writing, editing and formatting documents.

6.2 Web View

Web View displays the document in a way suitable for viewing as a web page.

It is useful when the document is intended for web-based presentation.

6.3 Full Screen View

Full Screen View displays the document using most or all of the available screen area, reducing interface elements.

It is useful when you want to concentrate on the document or get a larger working area.

7. Starting LibreOffice Writer

LibreOffice Writer can be started from the operating system's application menu.

A typical method is:

Applications/Menu → LibreOffice → LibreOffice Writer

The exact steps may differ depending on the operating system and LibreOffice installation.

8. Creating a New Document

A new Writer document can be created using:

File → New → Text Document

Keyboard Shortcut

Ctrl + N

Ctrl + N creates a new document.

9. Text Area

The **Text Area** is the main area where the user enters text.

When the cursor is visible in the text area, we can start typing using the keyboard.

The blinking vertical line is called the **insertion point** or **text cursor**.

It indicates where the next character will appear.

10. Word Wrap

Word Wrap is a feature that automatically moves a word to the next line when there is not enough space remaining on the current line.

Example

Suppose a sentence reaches the right margin:

Information Technology is an important

The next word may automatically move to the next line.

We do **not** need to press Enter at the end of every line.

Important

Press Enter only when you want to start a new paragraph or line intentionally.

11. Enter Key

The **Enter** key is generally used to:

- Start a new paragraph

- Move the cursor to the next paragraph
- Create a new paragraph

Example

My name is Rahul.

I study in Class IX.

Pressing Enter after the first sentence creates a new paragraph.

Remember

Word Wrap: Automatically moves text to the next line.

Enter: Creates a new paragraph.

12. Opening an Existing Document

To open an existing Writer document:

File → Open

or use the keyboard shortcut:

Ctrl + O

Then:

1. Select the required file.
2. Click **Open**.

13. Saving a Document

Saving stores the document for future use.

Use:

File → Save

or:

Ctrl + S

If the document is being saved for the first time, Writer asks for:

- File name

- Location/folder
- File type/format

Then click **Save**.

14. ODT – OpenDocument Text Format

By default, a new LibreOffice Writer document is saved in the **OpenDocument Text** format.

File Extension

.odt

ODT stands for **OpenDocument Text**.

Example:

MyAssignment.odt

Important

- **.odt** → OpenDocument Text
 - It is the standard text-document format used by LibreOffice Writer.
 - Other formats such as .docx can also be opened and saved when required.
-

15. Closing a Document

After completing the work, we can close the current document.

Use:

File → Close

or click the **Close** button of the document window.

Important

Closing a document is different from exiting LibreOffice.

- **Close:** Closes the current document.
- **Exit:** Closes the LibreOffice application.

If there are unsaved changes, Writer may ask whether you want to **Save**, **Discard**, or **Cancel**.

16. Exiting LibreOffice Writer

To completely close LibreOffice Writer, use:

File → Exit LibreOffice

or the appropriate application close option.

Remember:

Close Document ≠ Exit Writer

17. Word Processing Terminology

Understanding common terminology is important when working with word processors.

17.1 Margin

A **margin** is the blank space between the edge of a page and the document's content.

There are generally four page margins:

- Top margin
- Bottom margin
- Left margin
- Right margin

Example

|← Margin →| Document Text

Margins help keep text away from the edges of the page.

18. Columns

Columns divide the page into two or more vertical sections.

For example:

```
| Column 1 | Column 2 |  
|-----|-----|  
|   Text   |   Text   |  
|   Text   |   Text   |
```

Columns are commonly used in:

- Newspapers
 - Magazines
 - Newsletters
 - Brochures
-

19. Word Wrapping

Word wrapping is the automatic movement of text to the next line when the current line reaches the margin.

Key Point

We don't need to press **Enter** after every line.

20. Indentation

Indentation is the amount by which a paragraph is moved inward from the page margin.

Types of paragraph indentation include:

- Left indent
- Right indent
- First-line indent
- Hanging indent

Example

Normal paragraph:

This is a paragraph.

Indented paragraph:

 This is an indented paragraph.

21. Paragraph Indentation vs Page Margins

These two concepts are often confused.

Page Margins	Paragraph Indentation
Define the boundary of the page content area.	Changes the position of a particular paragraph.

Usually applies to the page/page style.	Applies to selected paragraph(s).
Includes top, bottom, left and right margins.	Includes left, right, first-line and hanging indentation.
Creates space between page edge and content.	Moves paragraph text inward or changes its first line position.

Simple Example

Margin:

Controls where the document's content area begins.

Indentation:

Controls where a particular paragraph begins within that content area.

22. Font Style and Font Size

Font

A **font** is the design/style of characters used in a document.

Examples:

- Liberation Serif
- Liberation Sans
- Carlito
- DejaVu Sans

Font Size

Font size determines the relative size of characters.

Examples:

- 10 pt
- 12 pt
- 14 pt
- 16 pt
- 20 pt

Example

12 pt: Computer

20 pt: Computer

23. Text Attributes

Text attributes are formatting characteristics applied to text.

Common text attributes include:

Bold

Makes text darker/thicker.

Example: Computer

Shortcut: **Ctrl + B**

Italic

Makes text slanted.

Example: *Computer*

Shortcut: **Ctrl + I**

Underline

Adds a line below text.

Example: Computer

Shortcut: **Ctrl + U**

Other text attributes include:

- Font colour
- Highlighting
- Superscript
- Subscript
- Strikethrough
- Font size
- Font type

24. Text Alignment

Alignment determines the position of text within the available space.

The four common horizontal alignments are:

Alignment	Description	Common Shortcut
Left	Text starts from the left margin.	Ctrl + L
Center	Text is placed in the centre.	Ctrl + E
Right	Text ends at the right margin.	Ctrl + R
Justified	Text is aligned with both left and right margins. Ctrl + J	

Example

Left Alignment

Computer Education
is important.

Center Alignment

Computer Education
is important.

Right Alignment

Computer Education
is important.

Justified Alignment

Text is distributed so that both left and right edges are aligned, except where the final line does not require full justification.

25. Horizontal and Vertical Alignment

Horizontal Alignment

Controls the position of text from **left to right**.

Examples:

- Left
- Center
- Right
- Justified

Vertical Alignment

Controls the position of content from **top to bottom** within a page or container.

Examples:

- Top
- Center
- Bottom

Note: In normal Writer paragraphs, horizontal alignment is used much more frequently. Vertical alignment is particularly useful for page layouts, tables, frames and other objects.

26. Line Spacing

Line spacing is the amount of vertical space between lines of text in a paragraph.

Common options include:

- Single
- 1.15
- 1.5
- Double

Example

Single spacing:

This is the first line.

This is the second line.

Double spacing:

This is the first line.

This is the second line.

Line spacing can improve the readability of a document.

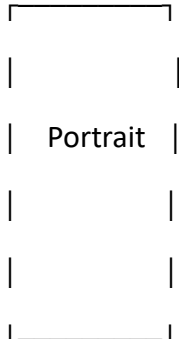
27. Page Orientation

Page orientation determines whether a page is arranged vertically or horizontally.

There are two main orientations:

Portrait

The page is taller than it is wide.



Commonly used for:

- Letters
- Applications
- Reports
- School assignments

Landscape

The page is wider than it is tall.



Commonly used for:

- Wide tables
- Charts
- Presentations
- Wide documents

28. Headers and Footers

Header

A **header** is an area at the **top of a page** where information can be placed.

Examples:

- School name
- Document title
- Chapter name
- Logo

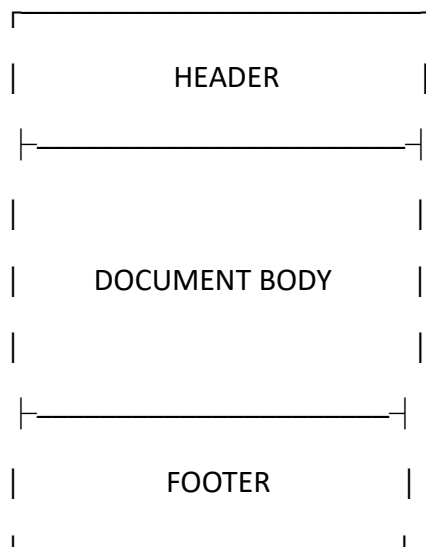
Footer

A **footer** is an area at the **bottom of a page**.

Examples:

- Page number
- Date
- Author name
- Copyright information

Simple Representation



Headers and footers are particularly useful for documents containing multiple pages.

29. Important Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut Function

Ctrl + N Create a new document

Shortcut Function

Ctrl + O Open an existing document

Ctrl + S Save the document

Ctrl + B Bold

Ctrl + I Italic

Ctrl + U Underline

Ctrl + L Left align

Ctrl + E Center align

Ctrl + R Right align

Ctrl + J Justify

30. Quick Revision

Remember these important points:

1. **LibreOffice Writer** is a word processing application.
2. A **word processor** is software used to create, edit, format, save and print documents.
3. The default LibreOffice Writer document format is **ODT**.
4. **.odt** means **OpenDocument Text**.
5. **Ctrl + N** → New document.
6. **Ctrl + O** → Open document.
7. **Ctrl + S** → Save document.
8. **Word Wrap** automatically moves text to the next line.
9. **Enter** is used to start a new paragraph.
10. **Margins** define the space between the page edge and content area.
11. **Indentation** changes the position of a paragraph within the content area.
12. **Portrait** is vertical page orientation.
13. **Landscape** is horizontal page orientation.
14. **Header** appears at the top of a page.

15. **Footer** appears at the bottom of a page.
 16. **OLE** stands for **Object Linking and Embedding**.
 17. **Mail Merge** creates multiple personalized documents from common content and data.
 18. **Zoom** changes the document's display size, not the actual font size.
 19. **Close** closes the current document.
 20. **Exit** closes the LibreOffice application.
-

31. Key Terms – One-Line Definitions

Term	Definition
Word Processor	Software used to create and manage text documents.
LibreOffice Writer	Free and open-source word processing software.
Digital Documentation	Creating and managing documents electronically.
Word Wrap	Automatic movement of text to the next line.
Margin	Blank space between the page edge and content.
Indentation	Moving paragraph text inward from the margin.
Font	Design/style of characters.
Font Size	Size of characters in a document.
Text Attribute	A characteristic used to change text appearance.
Alignment	Positioning of text within the available space.
Line Spacing	Space between lines of text.
Page Orientation	Direction in which a page is arranged.
Header	Area at the top of a page.
Footer	Area at the bottom of a page.
OLE	Object Linking and Embedding.

Term	Definition
Mail Merge	Creation of multiple personalized documents using common content and data.
ODT	OpenDocument Text file format.
Zoom	Changes the on-screen display size of a document.



Exam-Oriented Questions

Very Short Answer Questions

1. What is a word processor?
2. Name any two word processors.
3. What is the default file extension of LibreOffice Writer?
4. What is Word Wrap?
5. What is OLE?
6. What is Mail Merge?
7. What is a margin?
8. What is indentation?
9. What is a header?
10. What is a footer?

Short Answer Questions

1. Explain any four features of a word processor.
2. Differentiate between page margins and paragraph indentation.
3. Explain the difference between Word Wrap and the Enter key.
4. What is Mail Merge? Give two applications.
5. Explain the difference between Portrait and Landscape orientation.
6. What is the difference between a header and a footer?
7. Explain the four types of horizontal text alignment.
8. What is OLE? Differentiate between linking and embedding.

Practical Questions

1. Create a new Writer document.
 2. Type a paragraph and save it as an .odt file.
 3. Open an existing Writer document.
 4. Apply bold, italic and underline formatting.
 5. Change the font and font size of a paragraph.
 6. Apply left, centre, right and justified alignment.
 7. Change the page orientation from Portrait to Landscape.
 8. Insert a header and footer.
 9. Change the line spacing of a paragraph.
 10. Close the document and exit LibreOffice Writer.
-

★ Easy Flow to Remember

Create → Type → Edit → Format → Save → Close

This is the basic workflow for **creating a document using a word processor**.

3.6 Borders and Backgrounds | 3.7 Images, Shapes & Special Characters | 3.8 Columns

Software: LibreOffice Writer

Note: Menu names can vary slightly between LibreOffice versions. The steps below follow the current Writer interface where possible. LibreOffice's official documentation confirms that page borders and backgrounds are handled through **Page Style**.

3.6 Borders and Backgrounds

3.6.1 What is a Border?

A **border** is a line or decorative boundary placed around a page, paragraph, table, image or other document element.

In Writer, a **page border** belongs to the page style. Therefore, changing a page style's border can affect all pages using that style.

Uses of Page Borders

Page borders can be used to:

- Make a document attractive.
 - Highlight an important page.
 - Create a certificate or invitation.
 - Give a formal appearance to a document.
 - Separate the page from the surrounding area.
-

Adding a Page Border

Steps

Step 1: Open the document in **LibreOffice Writer**.

Step 2: Choose:

Format → Page Style

Step 3: Select the **Borders** tab.

Step 4: Choose a suitable border arrangement.

Step 5: Select:

- Line style
- Line width
- Line colour
- Distance/padding between border and content

Step 6: Click **OK**.

LibreOffice provides predefined border arrangements as well as a user-defined option where individual sides can be selected.

Page Style: Default Style

Organizer

Page

Background

Header

Footer

Borders

Columns

Footnote

Line arrangement

Default

User-defined

Line

Style

Width

0.05pt

Color

Black

Spacing to contents

Left

0.00"

Right

0.00"

Top

0.00"

Bottom

0.00"

☒ Synchronize

Shadow style

Position

Distance

0.07"

Color

Gray 6

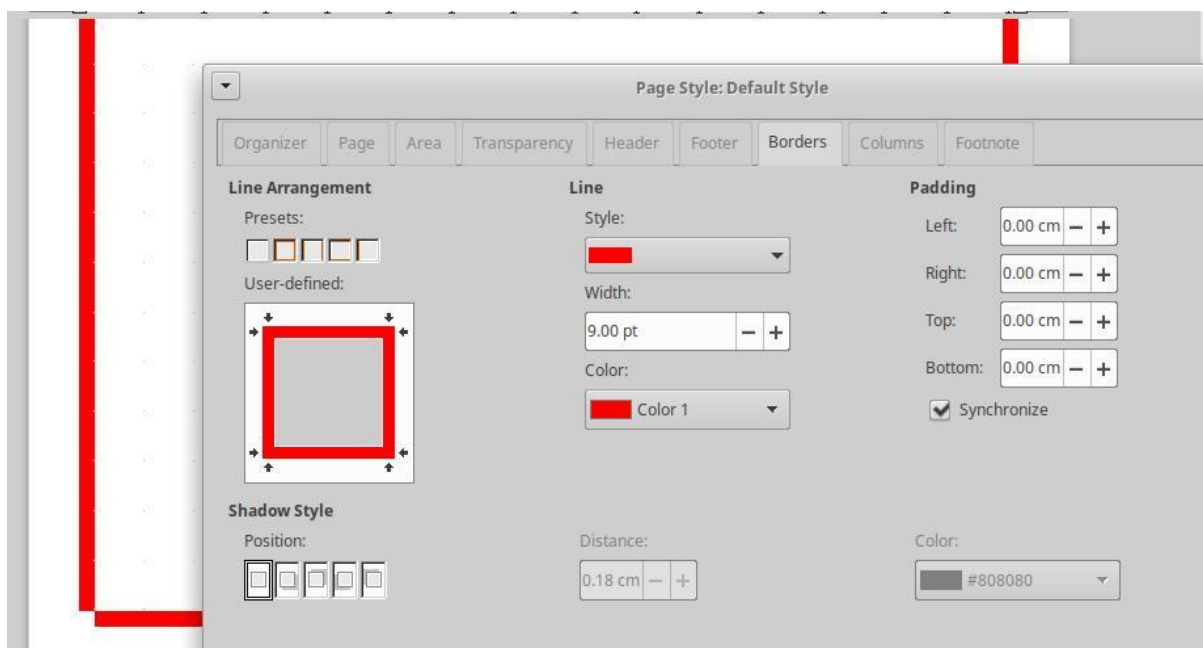
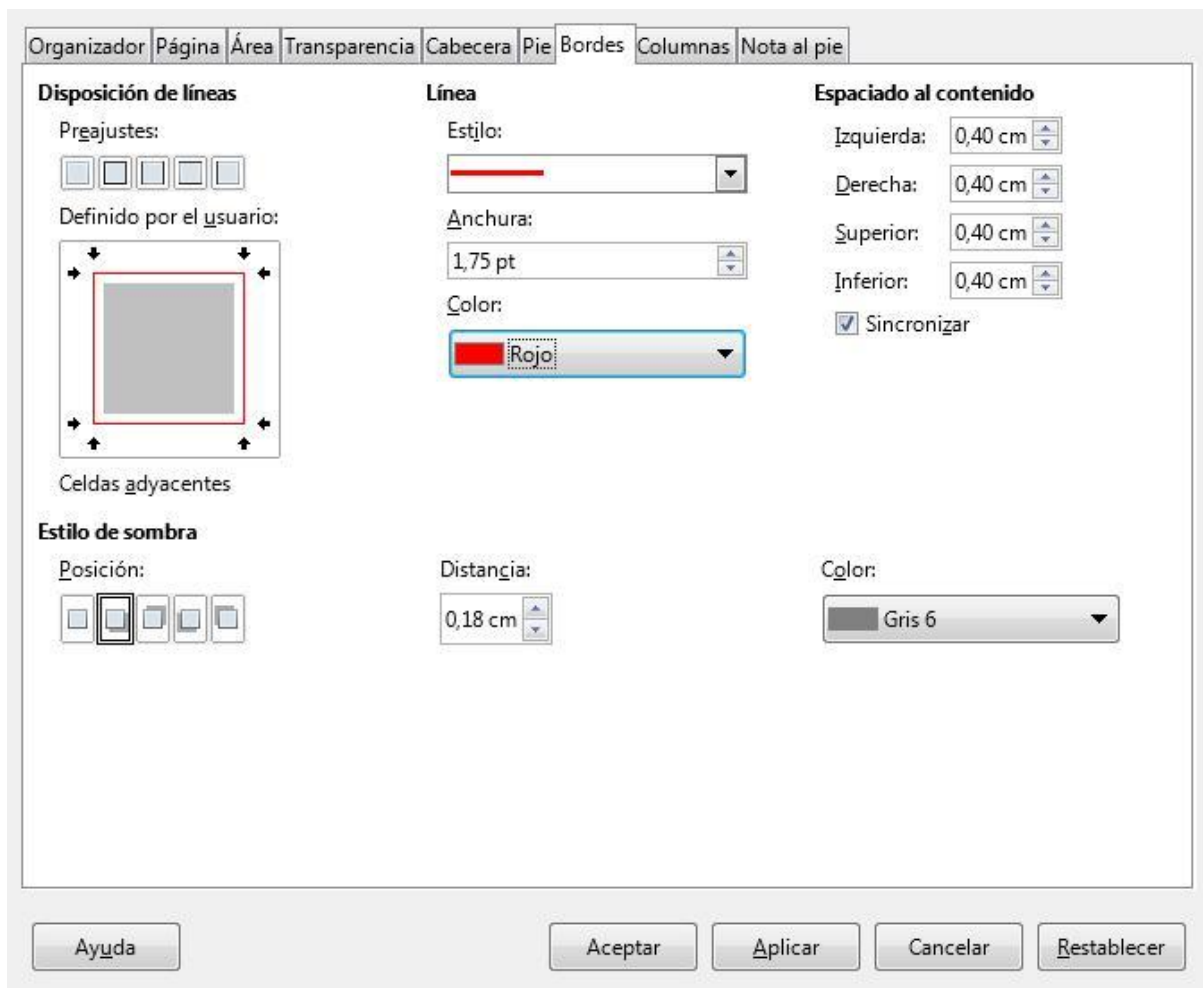
OK

Apply

Cancel

Help

Reset



4

Figure 3.6.1: Page Style – Borders

Remember

Format → Page Style → Borders → Select Border → Set Style/Width/Colour → OK

3.6.2 What is a Page Background?

A **page background** is a colour, gradient, pattern or image placed behind the content of a page.

A background can make a document visually attractive or can be used to create a watermark-like effect.

LibreOffice Writer allows a page background to be a **colour, gradient, hatching, pattern or bitmap/image**, depending on the available options.

Adding a Page Background

Steps

Step 1: Open the document in LibreOffice Writer.

Step 2: Choose:

Format → Page Style

Step 3: Select the **Area** tab.

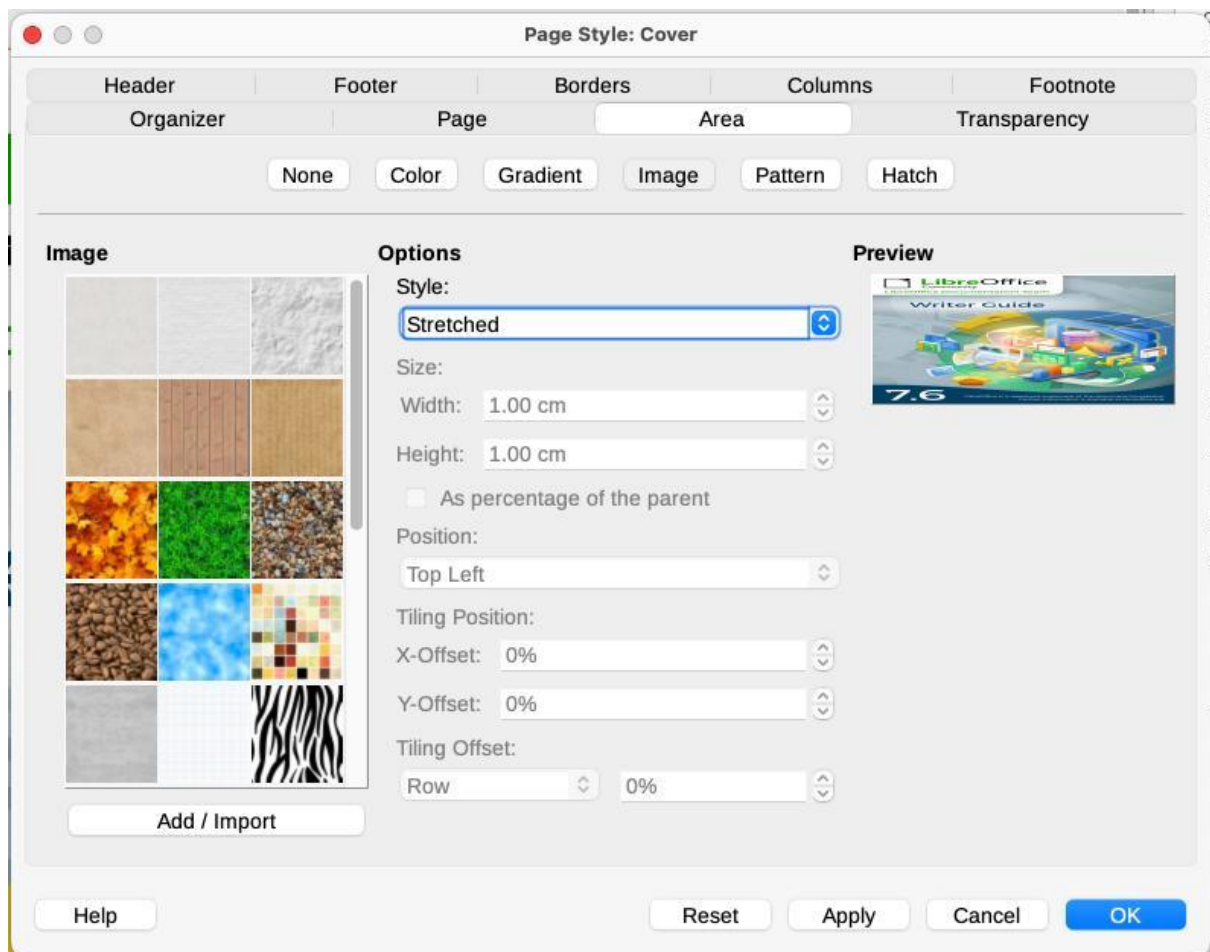
Step 4: Choose the required background type:

- None
- Colour
- Gradient
- Hatching
- Bitmap/Image
- Pattern

Step 5: Select the required colour or image.

Step 6: Click **OK**.

LibreOffice's current help specifically documents **Format → Page Style → Area** for selecting a page background colour or graphic.



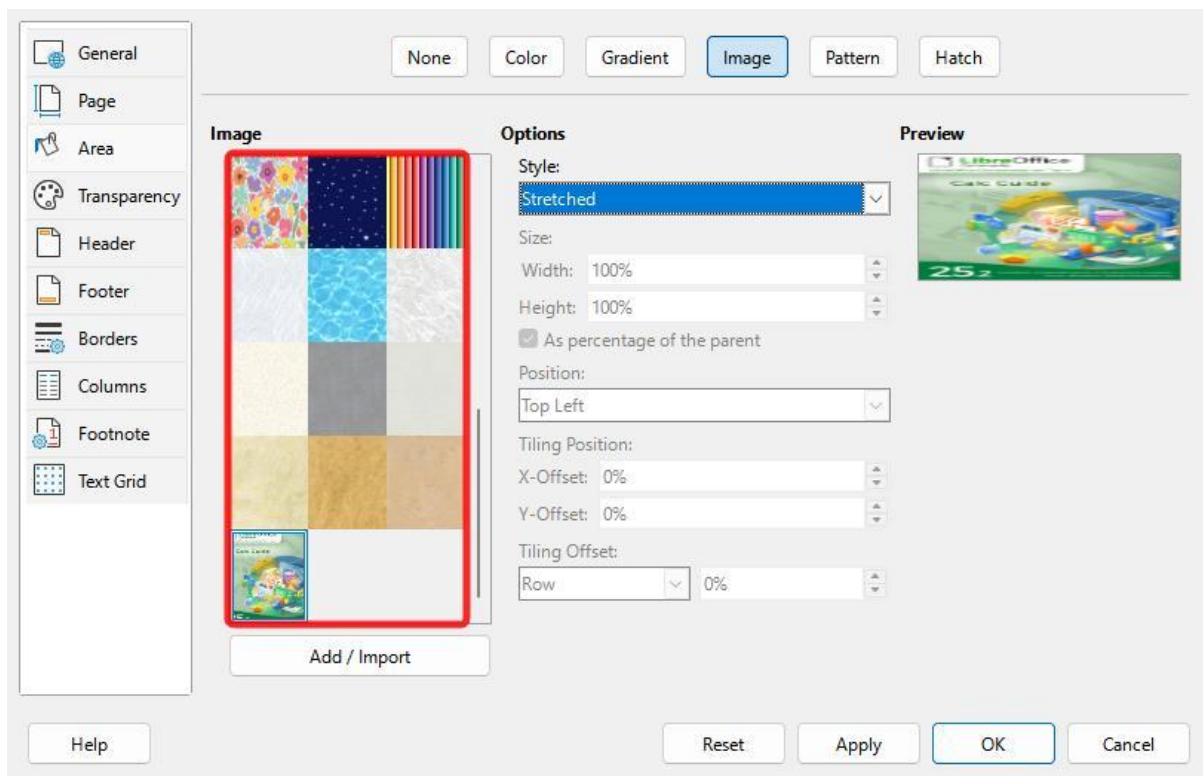
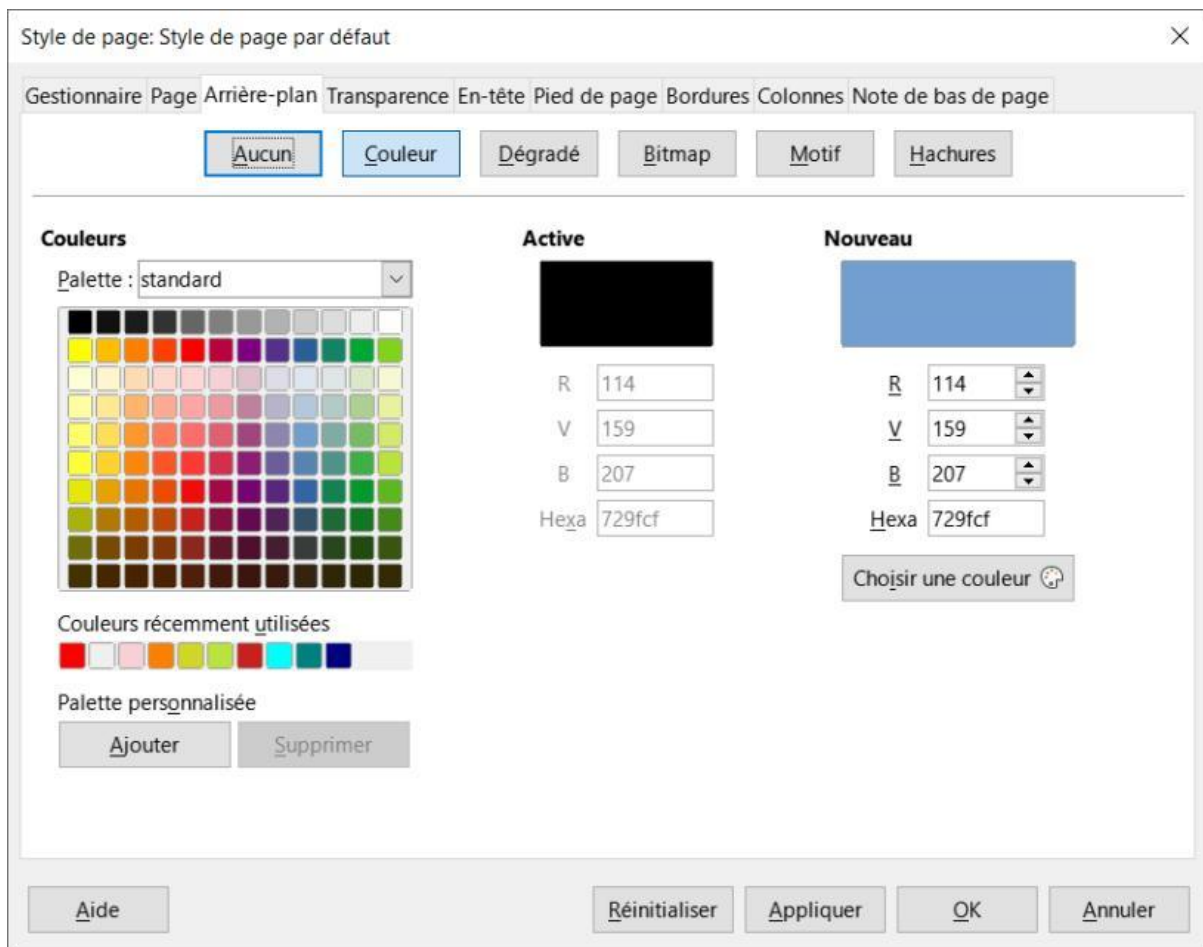


Figure 3.6.2: Page Style – Area/Background

Remember

Format → Page Style → Area → Select Background → OK

3.7 Inserting Images, Shapes and Special Objects

Images and drawing objects make a document more attractive and easier to understand.

Writer allows us to insert:

- Images
- Shapes
- Lines
- Arrows
- Callouts
- Flowcharts
- Text boxes
- Fontwork
- Charts
- Special characters

The Drawing toolbar provides many shapes, including rectangles, circles, arrows, stars, banners, callouts and flowchart shapes.

3.7.1 Adding Images

An **image** is a graphical object such as a photograph, logo, illustration or diagram inserted into a document.

Uses of Images

Images can be used to:

- Explain a concept.
- Make a document attractive.
- Add a school logo.
- Illustrate a report.

- Create posters and notices.

Steps to Add an Image

Step 1: Place the cursor where you want to insert the image.

Step 2: Choose:

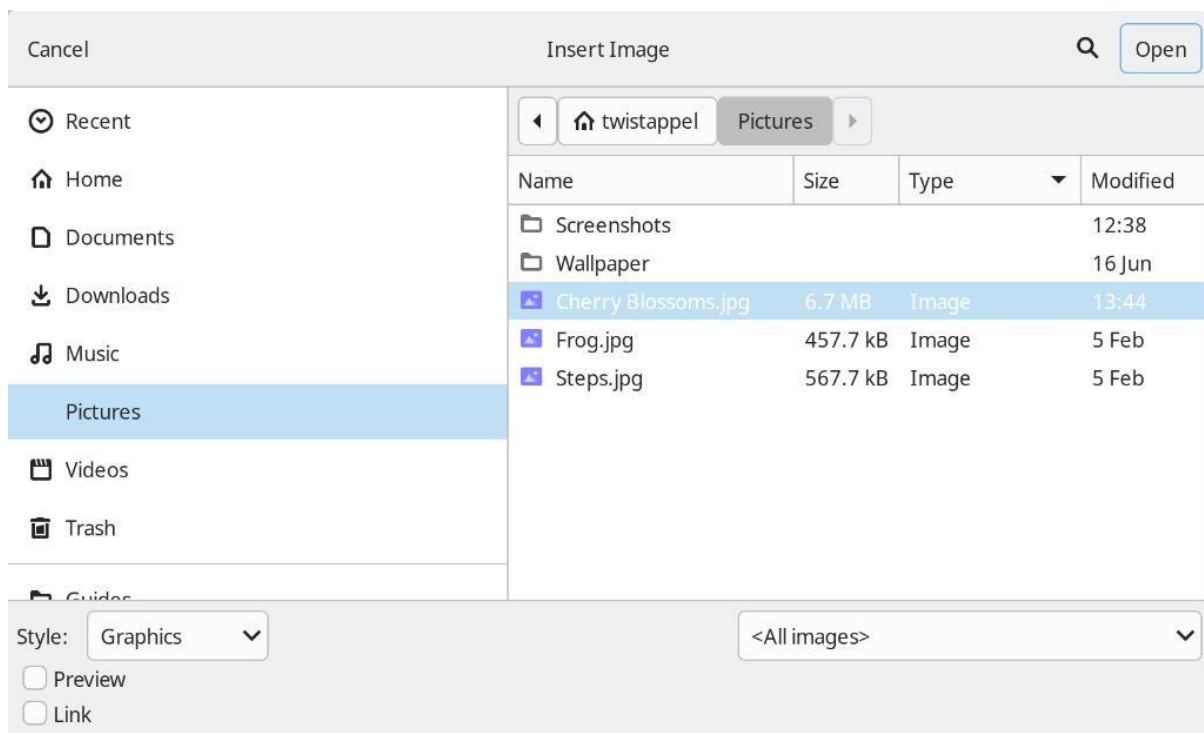
Insert → Image

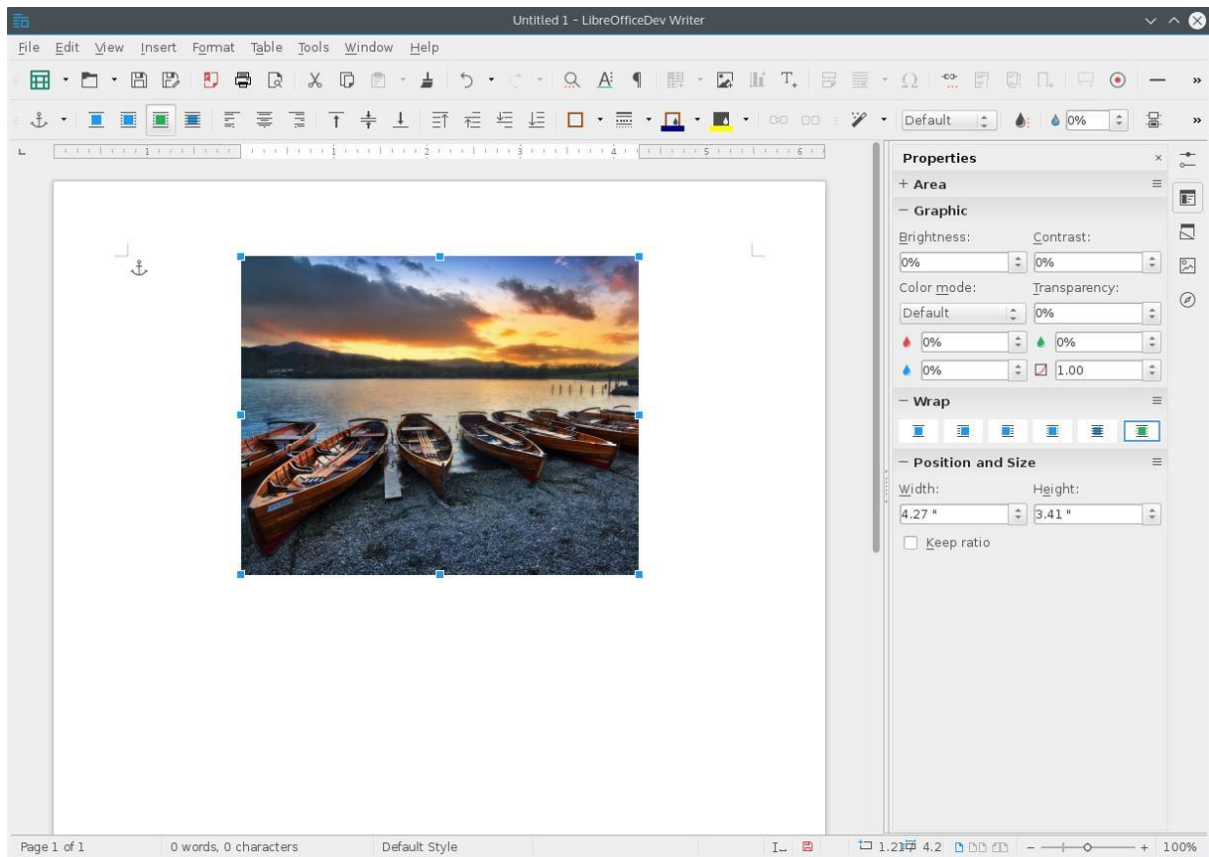
Step 3: Browse to the location of the image.

Step 4: Select the required image.

Step 5: Click **Open**.

The image will be inserted into the Writer document.





em ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Nunc vestibulum ligula ante, quis gravida risus bibendum placerat. Nunc quis augue neque. Sed imperdiet, nulla eu vestibulum ullamcorper, massa felis feugiat nulla, at euismod velit ligula ac dui. Praesent ipsum nisl, auctor eu nunc vitae, pulvinar imperdiet leo. Ut in rutrum ipsum. Duis auctor dui ut nisl ullamcorper, ac fermentum leo lobortis. Vestibulum egestas fringilla nibh. Sed ligula elit, blandit eu augue vitae, ultricies auctor tellus. Proin a nibh fermentum, finibus neque in, iaculis quam. Proin tempus nulla at velit congue, sed ultricies nulla venenatis. Maecenas ligula arcu, venenatis vel enim sed, cursus pellentesque erat.



>Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Nunc vestibulum ligula ante, quis gravida risus bibendum placerat. Nunc quis augue neque. Sed imperdiet, nulla eu vestibulum ullamcorper, massa felis feugiat nulla, at euismod velit ligula ac dui. Praesent ipsum nisl, auctor eu nunc vitae, pulvinar imperdiet leo. Ut in rutrum ipsum. Duis auctor dui ut nisl

ullamcorper, ac fermentum leo lobortis. Vestibulum egestas fringilla nibh. Sed ligula elit, blandit eu augue vitae, ultricies auctor tellus. Proin a nibh fermentum, finibus neque in, iaculis quam. Proin tempus nulla at velit congue, sed ultricies nulla venenatis. Maecenas ligula arcu, venenatis vel enim sed, cursus pellentesque erat.

Figure 3.7.1: Inserting an Image

Quick Method

You can also use the **Image** command from the Insert toolbar. LibreOffice documentation describes this command as opening a file-selection dialog to insert an image into the current document.

3.7.2 Adding Shapes

Shapes are predefined drawing objects used to create diagrams, illustrations and designs.

Examples of Shapes

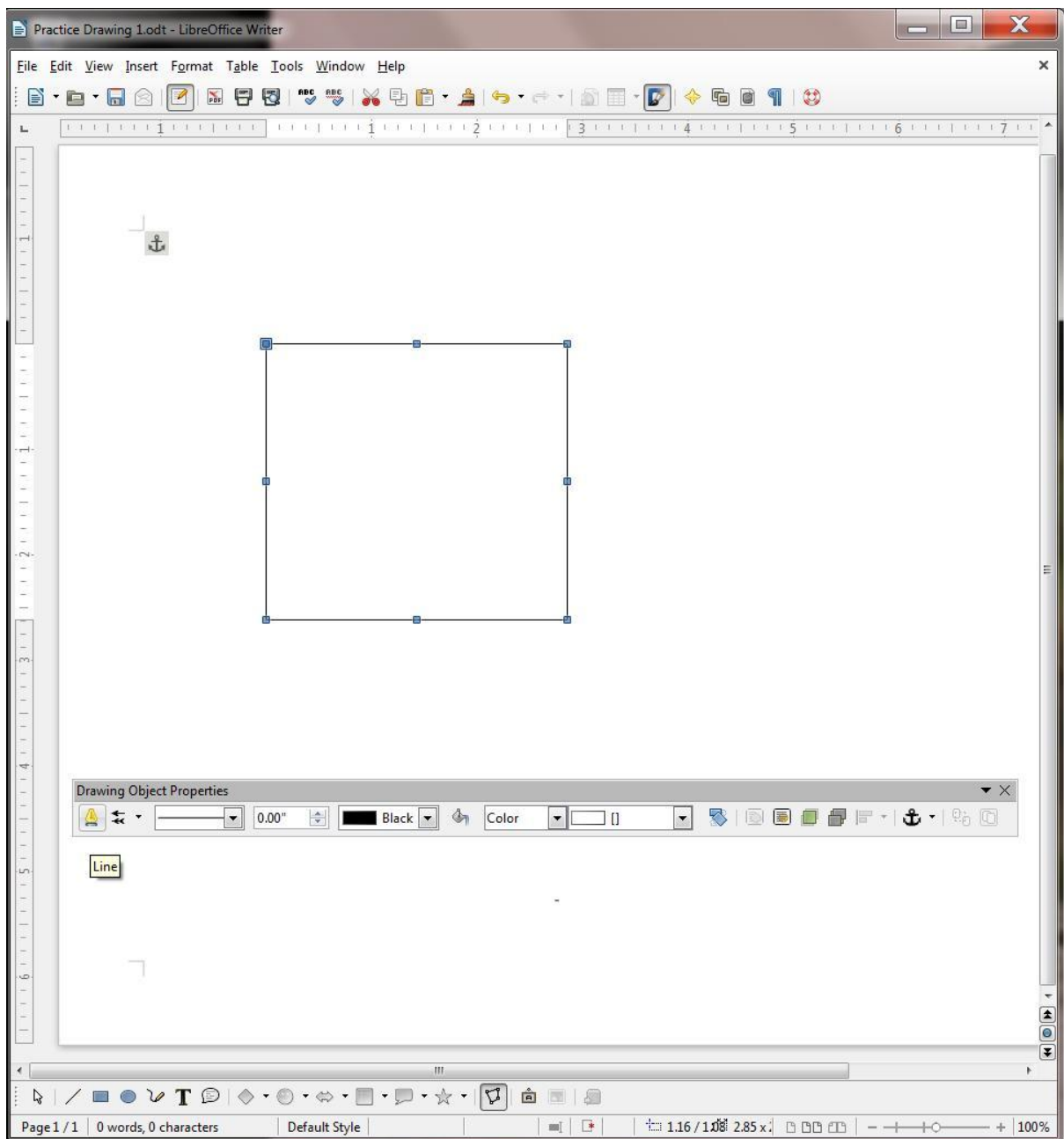
- Rectangle
 - Square
 - Circle
 - Ellipse
 - Triangle
 - Arrow
 - Star
 - Flowchart shapes
 - Callouts
 - Text boxes
-

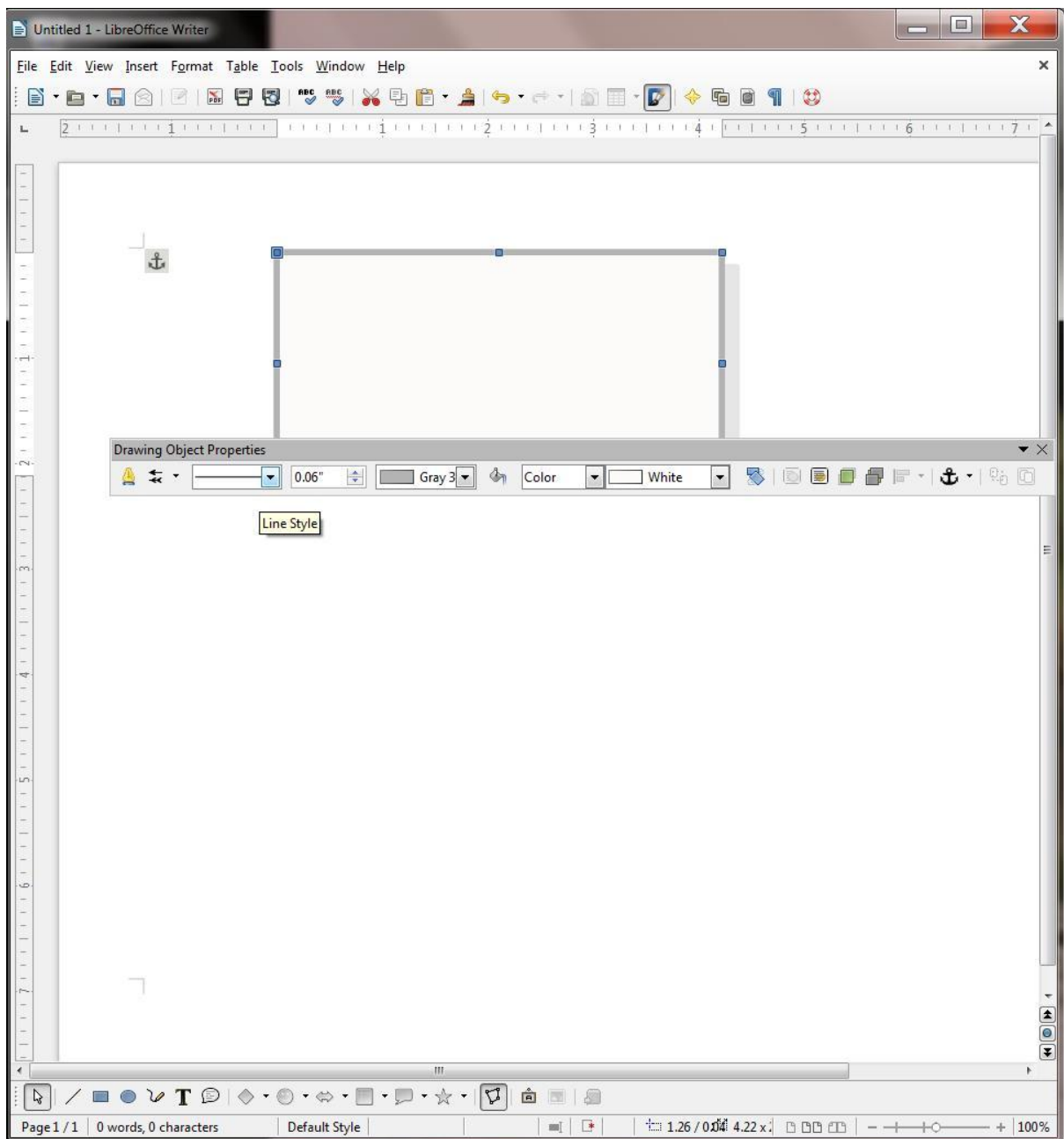
Showing the Drawing Toolbar

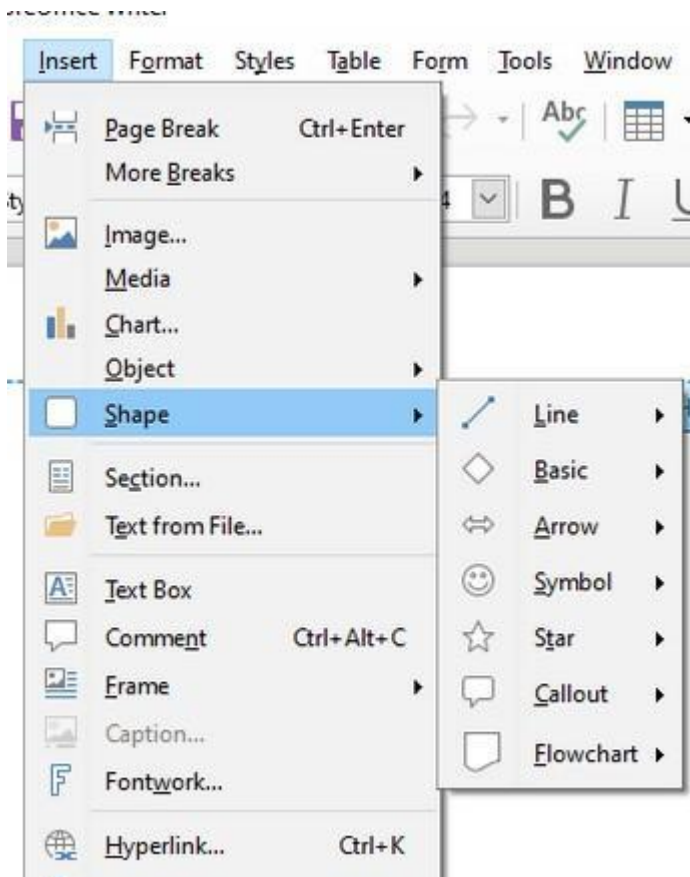
If the Drawing toolbar is not visible:

View → Toolbars → Drawing

The Drawing toolbar can also be displayed using the **Show Draw Functions** option.







6

Figure 3.7.2: Drawing Toolbar

Steps to Add a Shape

Step 1: Open the **Drawing toolbar**.

Step 2: Select the required shape.

Step 3: Move the mouse pointer to the required location.

Step 4: Click and drag to draw the shape.

Step 5: Release the mouse button.

The shape will be inserted into the document.

According to LibreOffice's documentation, selecting a drawing tool changes the pointer to drawing mode; clicking and dragging then creates the drawing object.

3.7.3 Formatting Shapes or Images

After inserting a shape or image, we can change its appearance, size and position.

A. Formatting Shapes

Steps

Step 1: Select the shape.

Step 2: Use the **Drawing Object Properties toolbar**.

You can also right-click the shape and use the available formatting/property options.

The Drawing Object Properties toolbar provides options such as line style, line width, line colour, fill colour, wrapping, alignment, layering and rotation.

Common Shape Formatting Tools

Tool	Purpose
Resize	Changes the height and width of the shape.
Colour/Fill	Changes the inside colour of the shape.
Borders/Line	Changes the outline of the shape.
Position	Moves the shape to a specific location.
Rotation	Rotates the shape.
Transparency	Makes the shape partly transparent.
Text Wrapping	Controls how text flows around the object.
Layering	Controls which object appears in front or behind another object.

Layering

Layering determines the order of overlapping objects.

Common commands include:

- Bring to Front
- Forward One
- Back One
- Send to Back

B. Formatting Images

After inserting an image, many properties can be changed.

Steps

Step 1: Select the image.

Step 2: Choose:

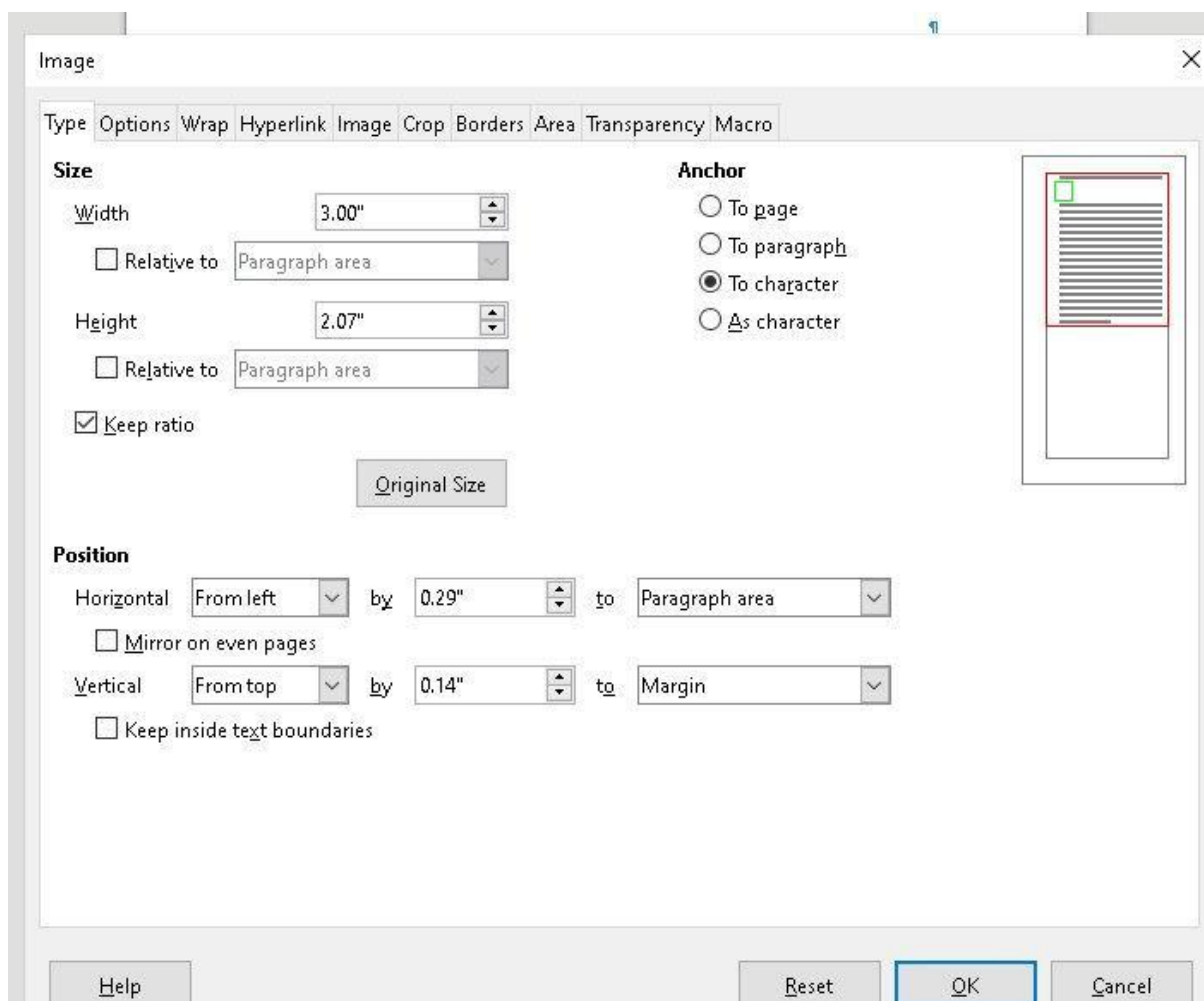
Format → Image

Step 3: Select the required formatting option.

For detailed image properties, use:

Format → Image → Properties

The exact menu wording may vary slightly between LibreOffice versions.



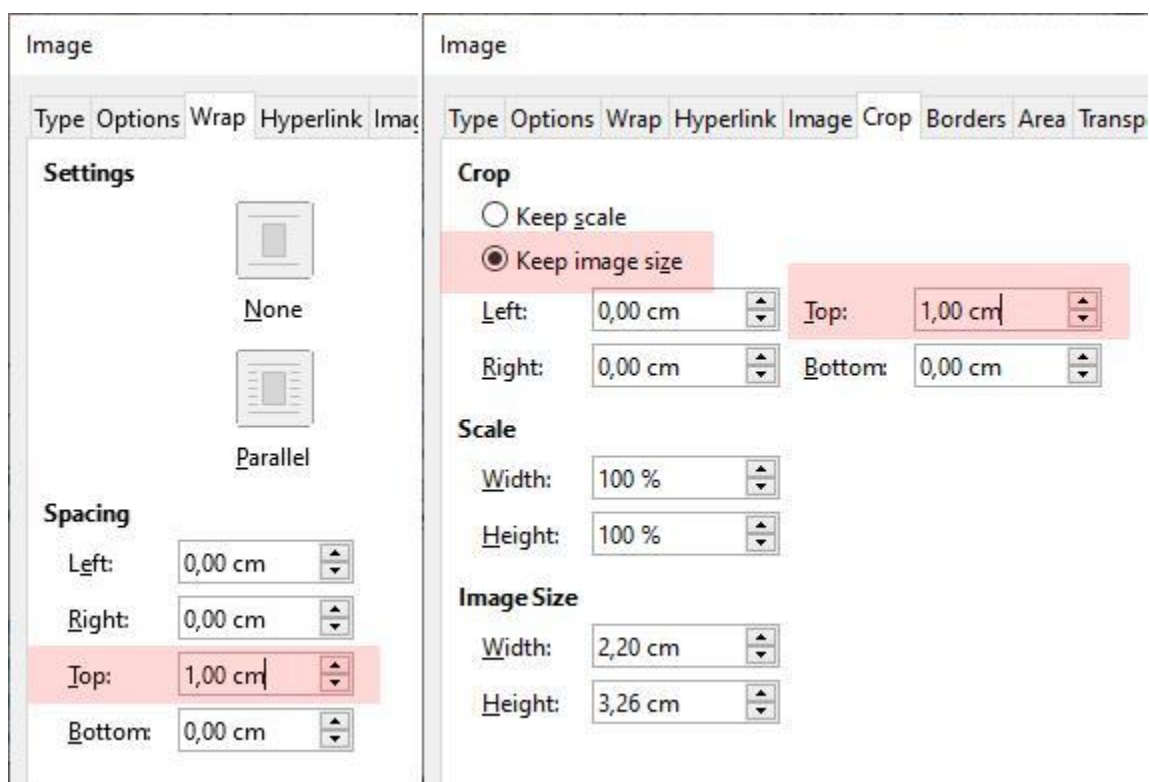
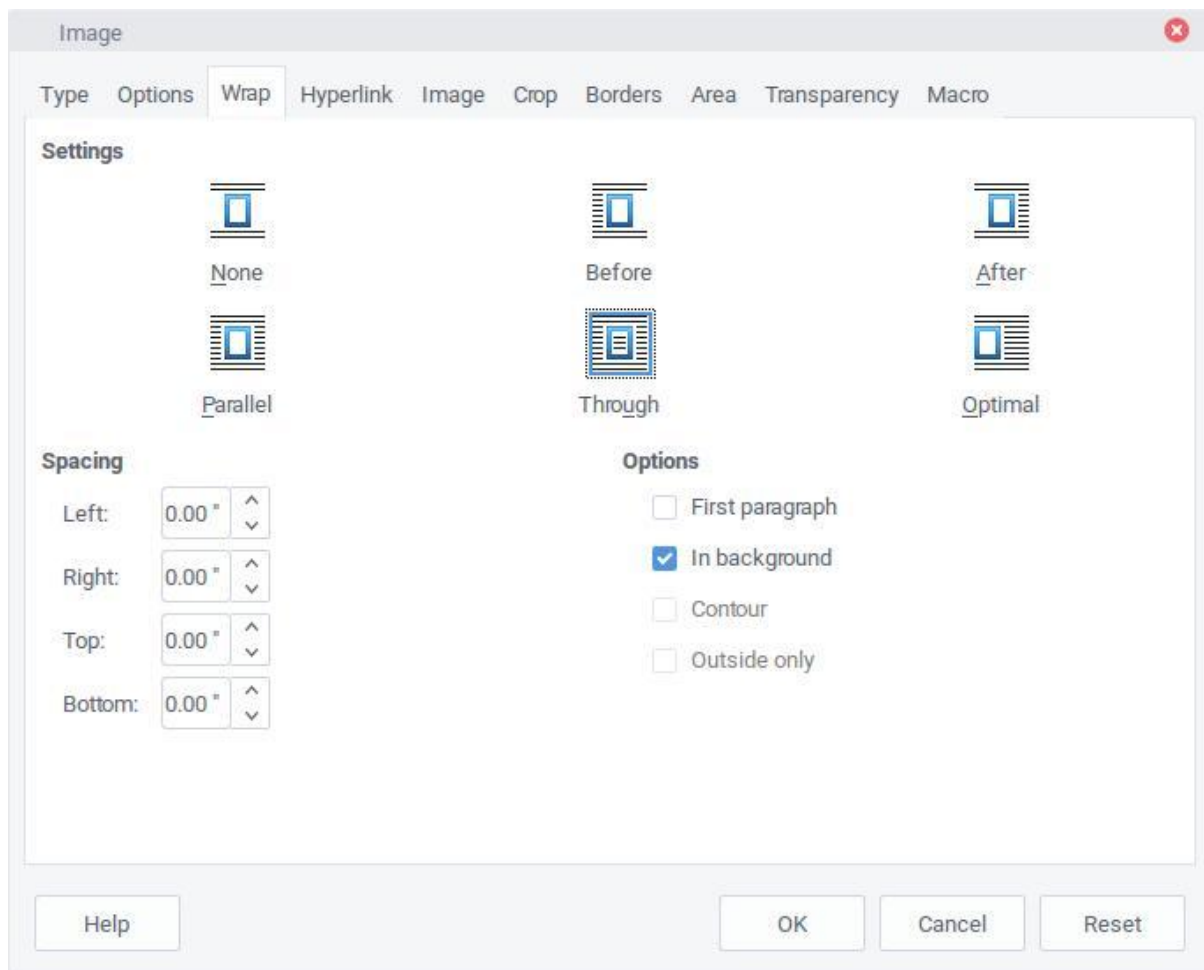


Figure 3.7.3: Image Properties

Common Image Formatting Options

1. Crop

Crop removes unwanted portions of an image.

Example:

If a photograph contains unnecessary background, cropping can remove it.

2. Compress

Compress reduces the size of an image or its data so that the document may require less storage space.

3. Resize

Resize changes the height and width of an image.

Tip: Maintain the image's aspect ratio when possible so that the image does not look stretched or distorted.

4. Rotate

Rotate turns the image around its centre.

For example:

- 90° clockwise
 - 90° anticlockwise
 - Custom angle
-

5. Flip

Flip creates a mirror-like version of an image.

It can be:

- Flipped horizontally
- Flipped vertically

6. Brightness and Contrast

Brightness controls how light or dark an image appears.

Contrast controls the difference between light and dark areas.

7. Transparency

Transparency controls how much of the background can be seen through an image.

8. Borders

A border can be added around an image.

We can change:

- Border style
 - Border colour
 - Border width
-

9. Shadows

A shadow can be applied to an image to give it a raised or three-dimensional appearance.

10. Colour

Image colour-related adjustments can be used to change the appearance of an image.

11. Position and Size

These options allow us to control:

- Exact position
 - Width
 - Height
 - Anchor
-

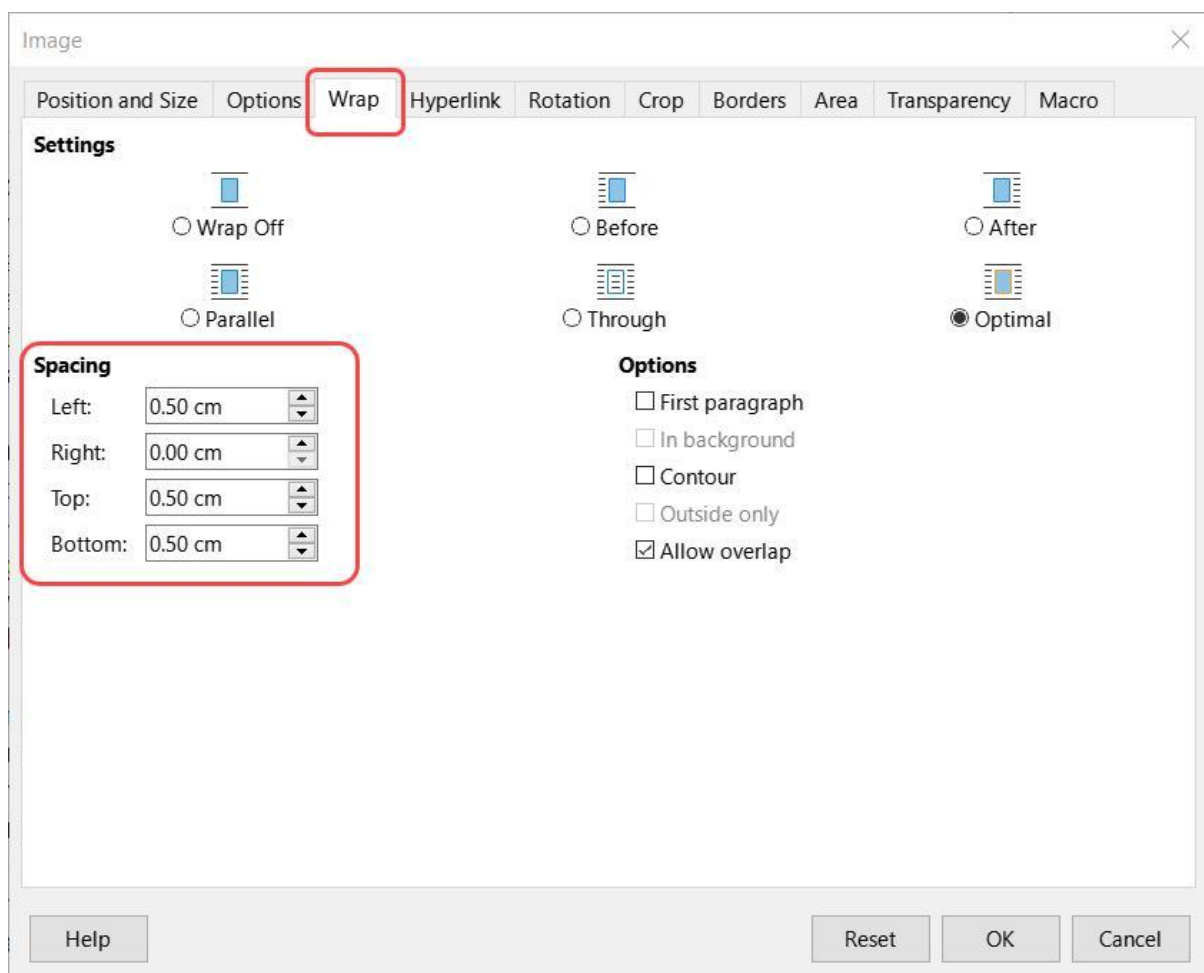
12. Text Wrapping

Text wrapping determines how text is arranged around an image.

Common wrapping options include:

- None / Wrap Off
- Before
- After
- Parallel
- Through
- Optimal

LibreOffice's image properties provide these wrap modes and spacing controls around the image.



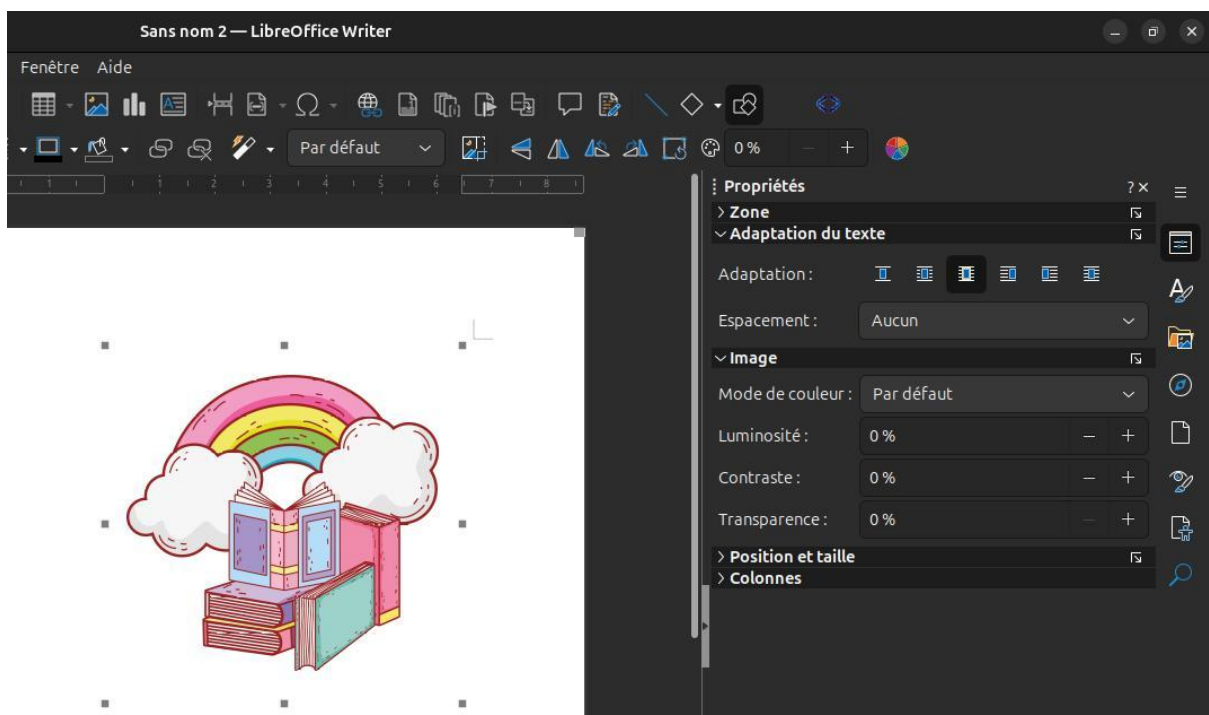
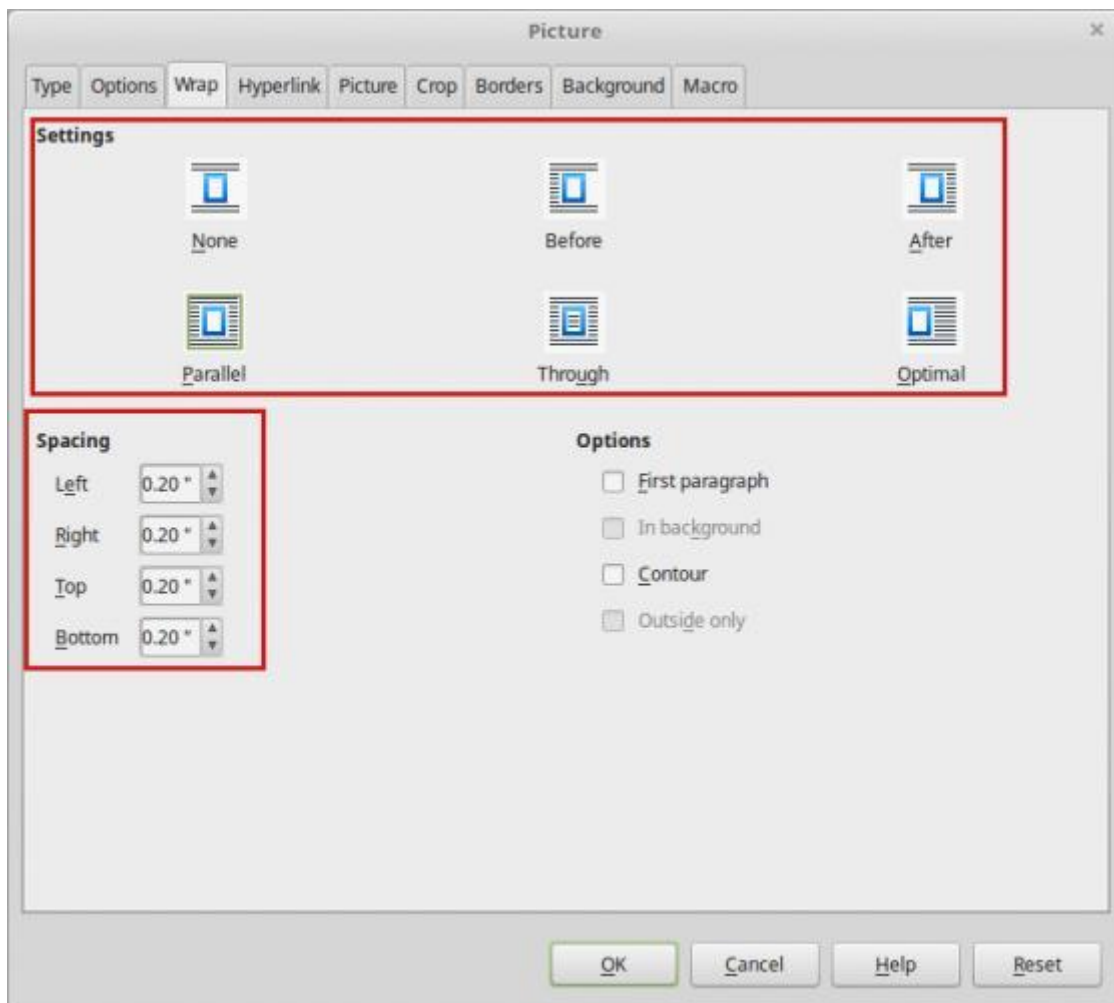


Figure 3.7.4: Text Wrapping Options

3.7.4 Inserting Special Characters and Non-Printing Characters

Special Characters

A **special character** is a character that may not be available directly on the keyboard.

Examples

- ©
- ®
- €
- ₹
- ±
- ≤
- ≥
- Ω
- ♥
- →
- §

Different fonts can provide different sets of special characters.

Steps to Insert a Special Character

Step 1: Choose:

Insert → Special Character

Step 2: Select the desired **font** and character.

Step 3: Select the required character.

Step 4: Click **Insert** or **OK**, depending on the LibreOffice version/interface.

Special Characters

Search:

Font:
Liberation Serif

Character block:
Basic Latin

	!	"	#	\$	%	&	'	(	)	*	+	,	-	.	/
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	:	;	<	=	>	?
@	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	[	\	]	^	_
`	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o
p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	{		}	~	
ı	¢	£	¤	¥	¦	§	¨	©	ª	«	¬		®	¯	°
±	²	³	´	µ	¶	·	,	¹	º	»	¼	½	¾	¿	À

Recent Characters:

Favourite Characters:

€
¥
£
©
Σ
Ω
≤
≥
∞
π
†
‡

Help

Hexadecimal: U+
20

Decimal:
32

Add to Favourites

Insert

Cancel

Special Characters

Search:

Font:
Liberation Sans

Subset:
Latin-1

	!	"	#	\$	%	&	'	(	)	*	+	,	-	.	/
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	:	;	<	=	>	?
@	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	[	\	]	^	_
`	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l	m	n	o
p	q	r	s	t	u	v	w	x	y	z	{		}	~	
ı	¢	£	¤	¥	¦	§	¨	©	ª	«	¬		®	¯	°
±	²	³	´	µ	¶	·	,	¹	º	»	¼	½	¾	¿	À

Recent Characters:

Favorite Characters:

€
¥
£
©
Σ
Ω
≤
≥
∞
π
†
‡

Help

Hexadecimal: U+
A7

Decimal:
167

Add to Favorites

Insert

Cancel

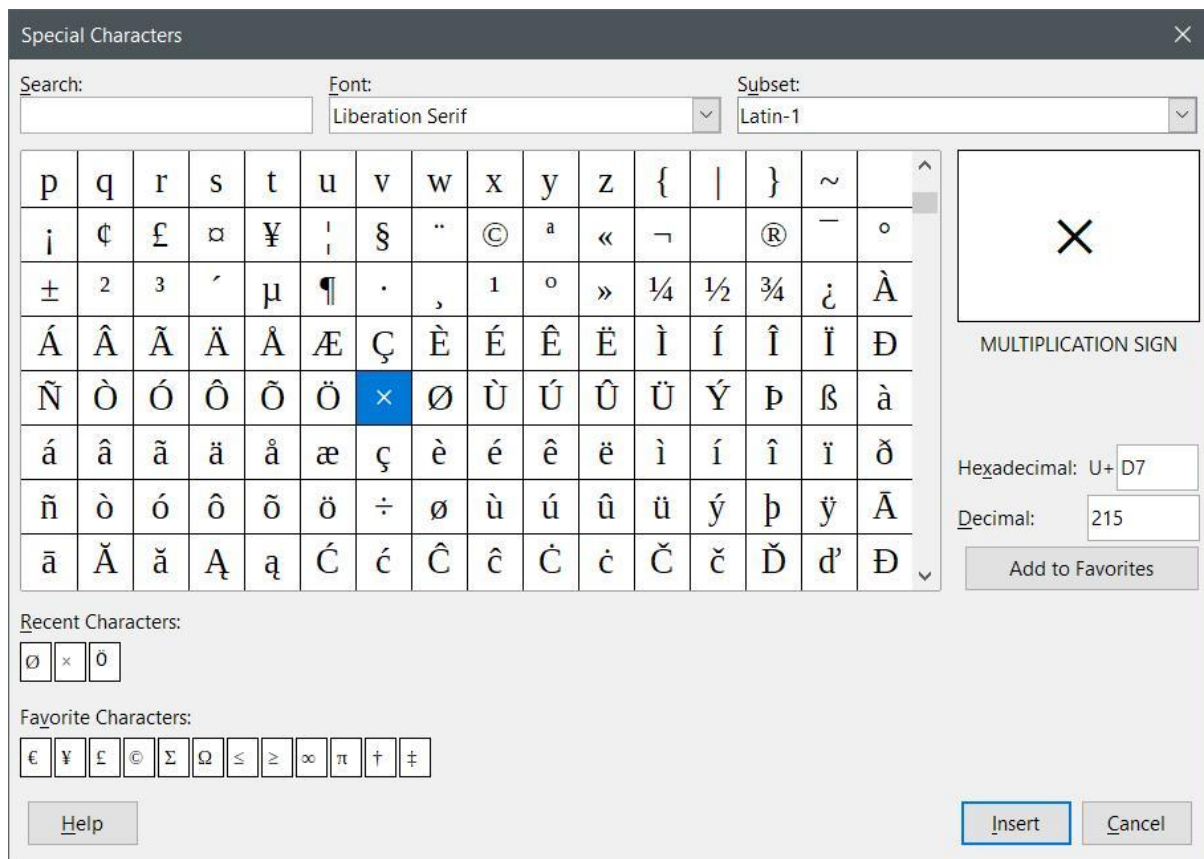


Figure 3.7.5: Special Characters Dialog

LibreOffice describes the Special Character command as a way to insert characters from the symbols available in installed fonts.

Non-Printing Characters

Non-printing characters are formatting marks that help us understand the structure of a document. They normally **do not appear when the document is printed**.

Examples include:

- Paragraph marks
- Spaces
- Tab marks
- Line breaks

Why are they useful?

They help us:

- Identify extra spaces.

- Find unnecessary paragraph breaks.
- Check tabs and indentation.
- Understand the structure of a document.
- Troubleshoot formatting problems.

Important Difference

Special Characters

Characters that can be inserted into a document.

Usually visible and printable.

Example: ©, ₹, Ω, ±

Inserted through **Insert → Special Character**.

Non-Printing Characters

Formatting marks used to show document structure.

Normally not printed.

Example: paragraph mark ¶, spaces, tab marks

Displayed using the **Formatting Marks / Non-printing Characters** option.

Remember: A special character is part of the document's content, while a non-printing character mainly helps us see its formatting structure.

3.7.5 Inserting a Chart

A **chart** is a graphical representation of numerical or categorical data.

Examples:

- Column chart
- Bar chart
- Pie chart
- Line chart
- Area chart

Steps to Insert a Chart

Step 1: Place the cursor at the required location.

Step 2: Choose:

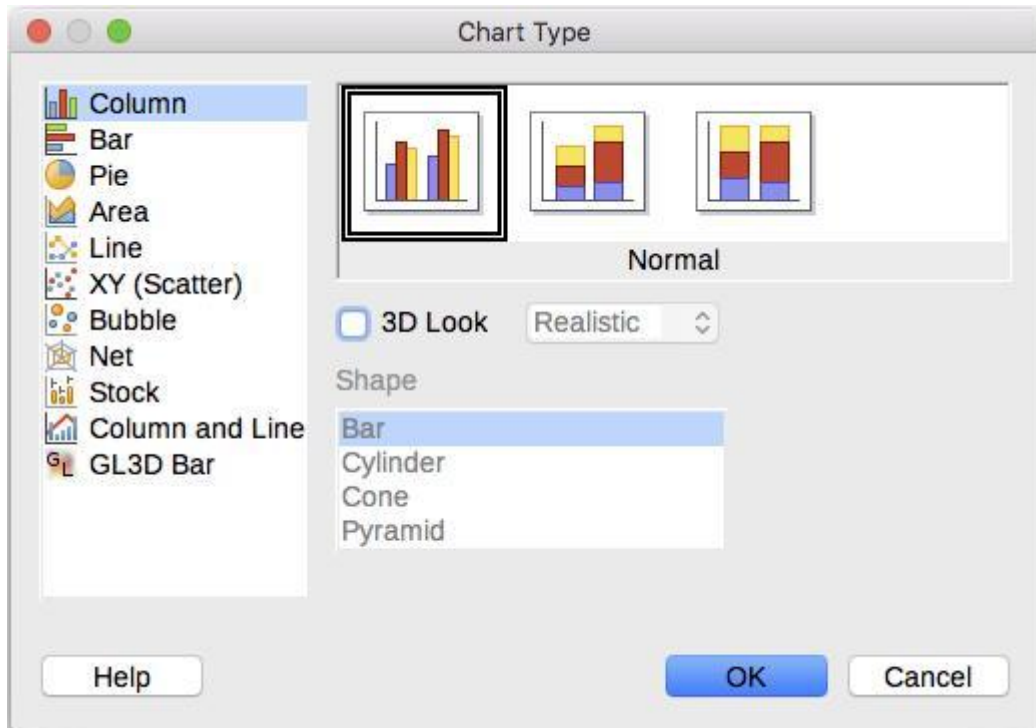
Insert → Chart

Step 3: A chart is inserted into the document.

Step 4: Enter or modify the data in the chart's data table.

Step 5: Select the appropriate chart type.

Step 6: Add or modify the chart title, labels and other settings.



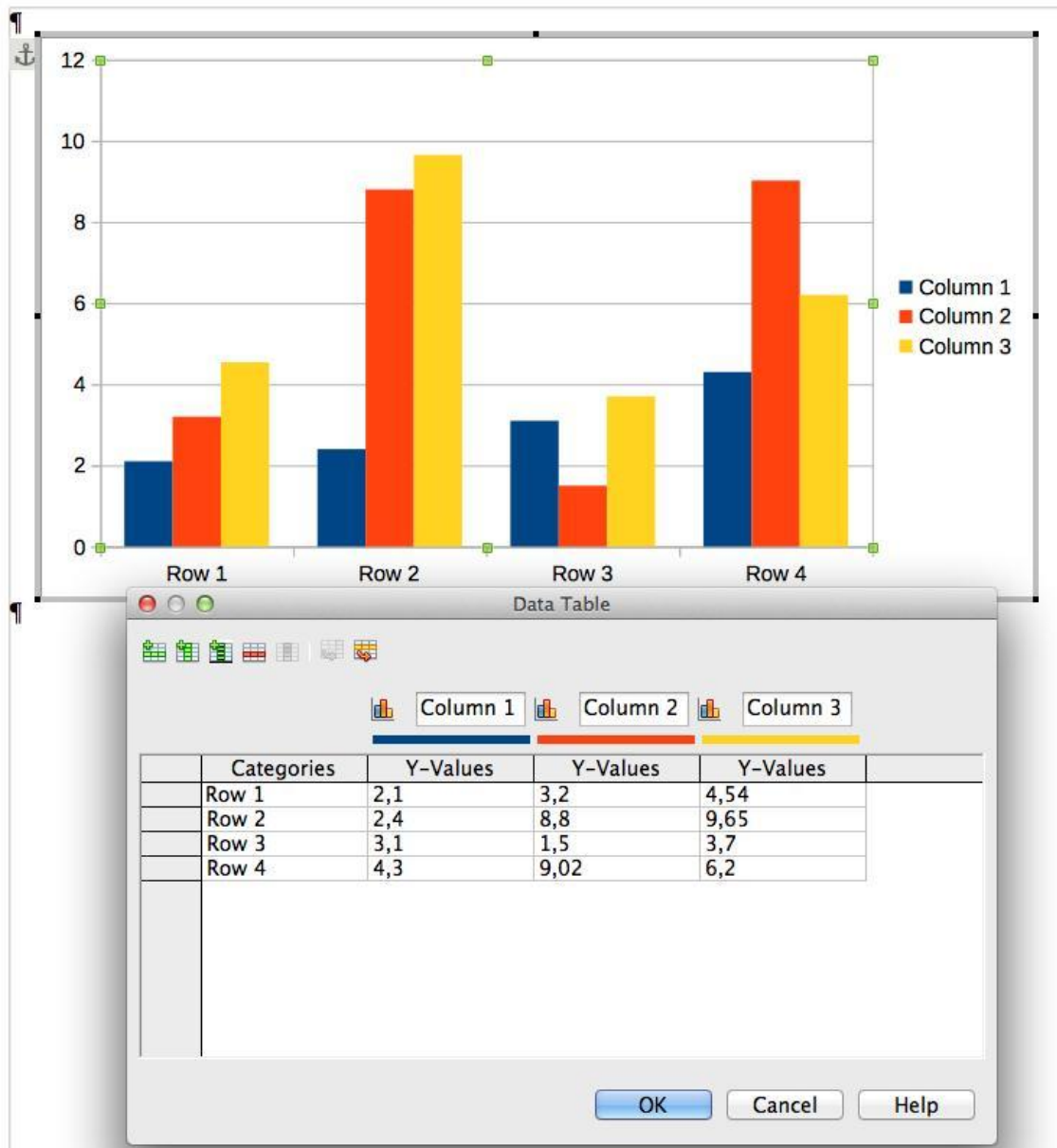




Figure 3.7.6: Chart in LibreOffice Writer

A Writer chart has an associated data table where values can be entered or edited.

Uses of Charts

Charts are useful for:

- Comparing data
- Showing trends
- Presenting statistics
- Making reports easier to understand

3.8 Dividing a Page into Columns

Note: Your earlier outline mentions **8.8**. For this Unit 3 sequence, it is more appropriate to number this section **3.8 – Dividing a Page into Columns**.

What are Columns?

Columns divide a page into two or more vertical sections so that text flows from one column to another.

Example

Column 1	Column 2
Text flows down this column first	Text continues here afterwards

Where are Columns Used?

Columns are commonly used in:

- Newspapers
- Magazines
- Newsletters
- Brochures
- School newsletters

Steps to Divide a Page into Columns

Method using Page Style

Step 1: Open the document in **LibreOffice Writer**.

Step 2: Choose:

Format → Page Style

Step 3: Select the **Columns** tab.

Step 4: Select the required number of columns.

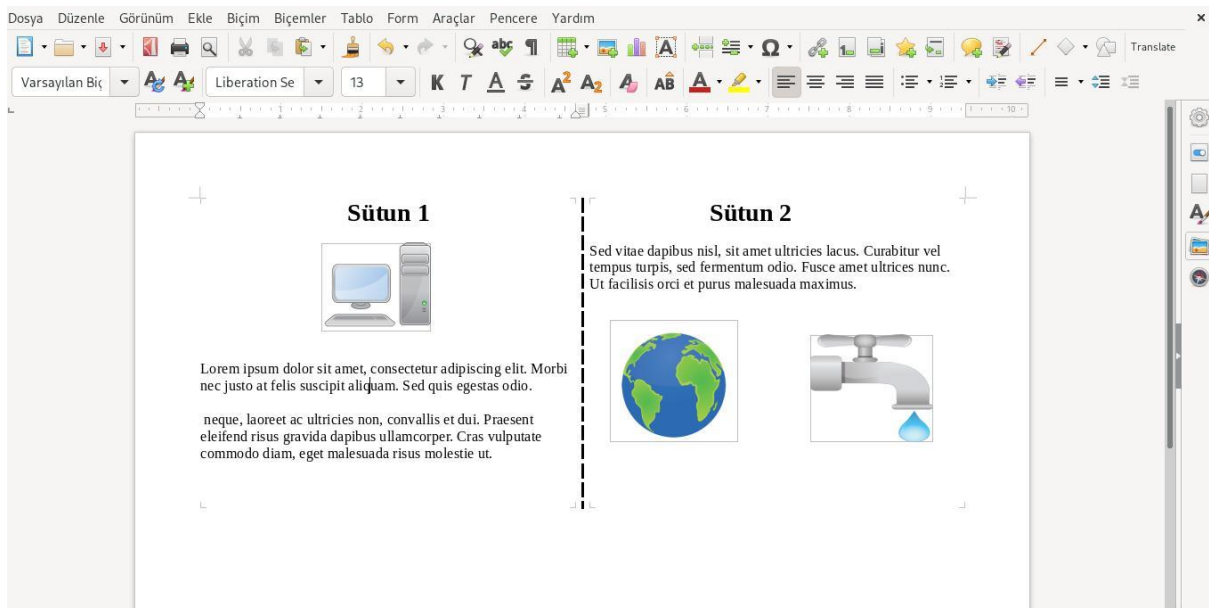
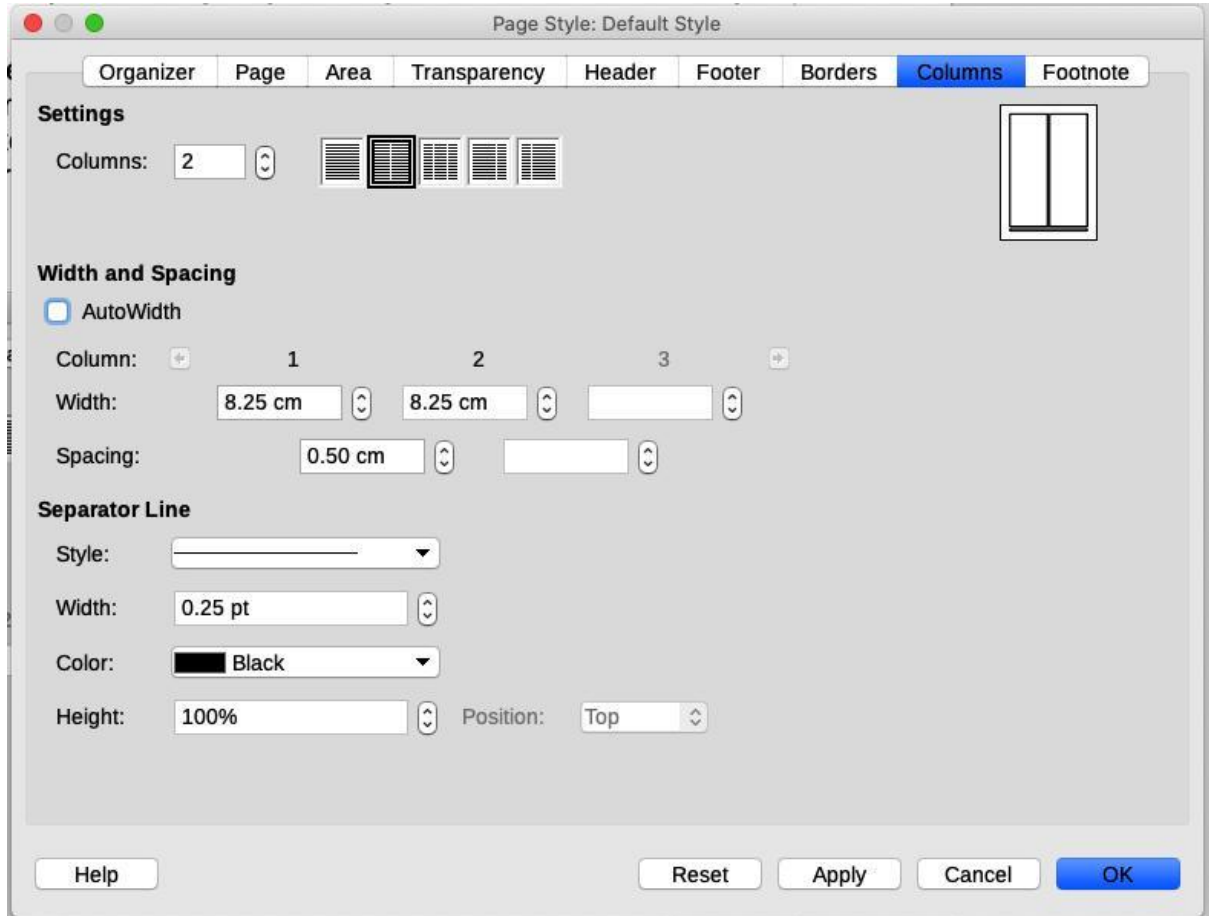
For example:

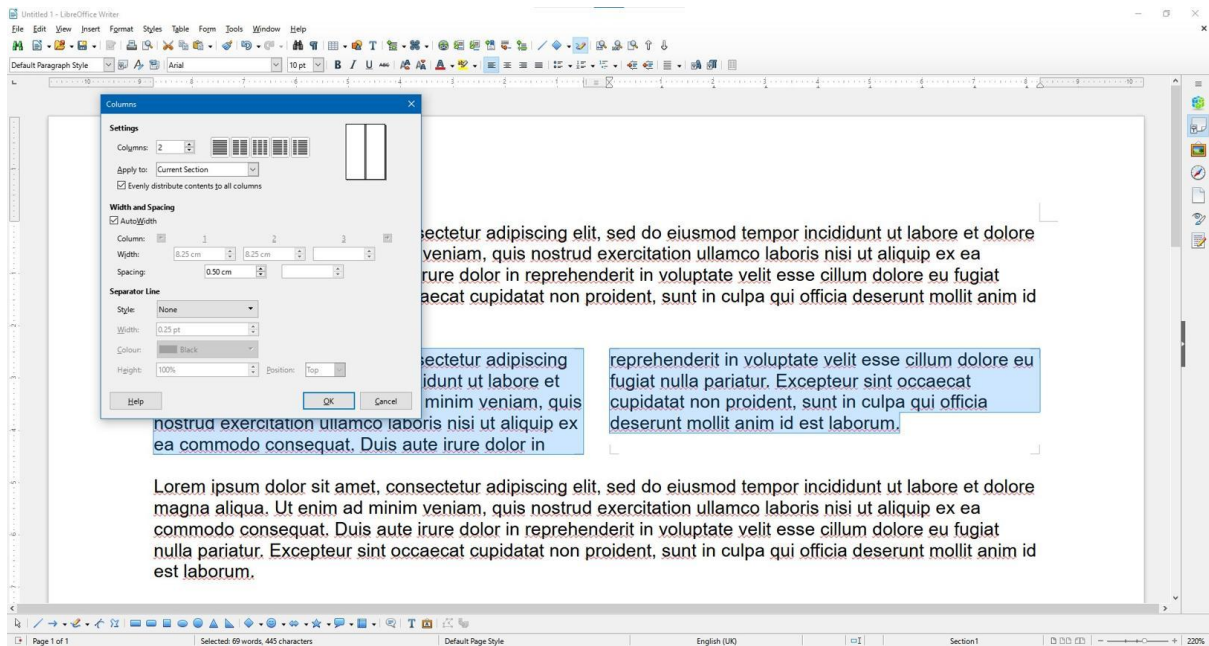
- 1 column
- 2 columns
- 3 columns

Step 5: Set the **spacing** between the columns.

Step 6: Click **OK**.

LibreOffice's Page Style dialog includes a Columns section for specifying the number and layout of columns for a page style.





4

Figure 3.8.1: Columns Dialog

Important

The **Columns** dialog can be used to control:

- Number of columns
- Column width
- Space between columns
- Separator line between columns

Quick Revision

Topic	Important Point
Page Border	Creates a boundary around the page.
Page Background	Adds colour, gradient, pattern or image behind page content.
Insert Image	Insert → Image
Insert Shape	Use the Drawing toolbar.
Resize	Changes object dimensions.
Crop	Removes unwanted portions of an image.

Topic	Important Point
Rotate	Turns an object around its centre.
Transparency	Makes an object partly transparent.
Text Wrapping	Controls how text flows around an object.
Layering	Controls front/back order of objects.
Special Character	A symbol such as ₹, © or Ω.
Non-printing Character	Formatting mark that normally does not print.
Chart	Graphical representation of data.
Columns	Divides a page into vertical sections.

Important Menu Paths to Remember

PAGE BORDER

Format → Page Style → Borders

PAGE BACKGROUND

Format → Page Style → Area

INSERT IMAGE

Insert → Image

DRAWING / SHAPES

View → Toolbars → Drawing

SPECIAL CHARACTER

Insert → Special Character

CHART

Insert → Chart

PAGE COLUMNS

Format → Page Style → Columns

Exam Tip: In practical questions, remember the sequence **Select → Choose Menu/Toolbar → Set Options → Apply/OK**. Menu names can differ slightly between LibreOffice releases, but the underlying functions remain the same.



Important Questions for Practice

1. What is a page border? Write the steps to add a page border.
2. What is a page background? How can you add a background to a page?
3. What is the purpose of inserting images in a document?
4. Write the steps to insert an image in LibreOffice Writer.
5. What are shapes? Name any five shapes available in Writer.
6. What is the Drawing toolbar?
7. Explain any five shape formatting options.
8. What is text wrapping?
9. What is the difference between **crop** and **resize**?
10. Write any five image formatting options.
11. What is a special character? Give three examples.
12. Write the steps to insert a special character.
13. What are non-printing characters? Give examples.
14. Differentiate between special characters and non-printing characters.
15. What is a chart? Why are charts useful?
16. Write the steps to insert a chart in Writer.
17. What are columns in a document?
18. Write the steps to divide a page into two columns.
19. What is the purpose of spacing between columns?
20. Differentiate between **page background** and **page border**.